Reviewer Guidelines

Welcome to Project Odin!!

Project Odin is an exciting initiative at the frontier of AI development. The goal is to capture realistic, professional macOS workflows to help train and evaluate AI systems. The recordings show how professionals use applications, menus, and system features to complete meaningful work.

These recordings help train and evaluate AI systems by showing **how real users interact with applications, menus, and macOS system behaviors**.

Your Role

Review tasks to ensure they meet Odin quality guidelines.

Before you start

- New reviewers: complete the onboarding in the New Reviewers section of the Canvas pinned in #odin-new-reviewers-hub. **You will not have Studio access to start live reviews until you have completed onboarding and passed the reviewer screening quiz.**
- Run Insightful while doing onboarding (reading the guidelines, going to an onboarding call, and taking the quiz).
- **Device:** Reviewers don't need a Mac. Reviews are done in Studio through your browser, on Mac or Windows. (Writers record on macOS, so you'll need a Mac only if you also want to write tasks)
- **OTA accounts:** TaskRecorder 2.4.4 does not require an OTA account or sign-in. App-login and privacy rules still apply if you also write tasks.
    - Go to the Odin Dashboard. Use the current writer onboarding guide for TaskRecorder 2.4.4 setup; the recorder no longer requires OTA sign-in.
    - A missing OTA assignment does not block TaskRecorder 2.4.4 recording. Follow the existing app-login requirements when a task needs an account.
- Writing tasks as a reviewer promoted from writer: when the review queue is empty, you are expected to write tasks. Keep your Insightful timer running while you write. You stay on your hourly rate and your hourly bonuses still apply; writer bonuses (per-task, sprint and boost) do not. See the Oct 15 announcement in #odin--reviewers.
- If you joined Odin directly as a reviewer, the write-when-the-queue-is-empty rule does not apply to you yet. If you choose to write tasks, do not run Insightful while writing.
- The Writer Guide covers what writers are told, particularly the Task Ideation and Studio Workflow pages.

The Reviewer Assessment

Promoted Writers:

- If you were promoted from writer to reviewer and you received first-pass approvals on 4 of your last 5 tasks, you do not need to complete the assessment. You may start reviewing immediately.
    - Please still reference the guides and the #odin–reviewers channel for questions.

Outside Hires:

- If you were contracted as a reviewer and have never been a writer on this project or you did not have first-pass approvals on 4 of your last 5 tasks as a writer, you must take the Reviewer Assessment in the Odin Dashboard.
- **To pass a video, you need both:**
    - **A score of 80% or higher, and**
    - **If taking**
        - **Quiz 1: no more than 1 CRITICAL miss**
        - **Quiz 2: NO CRITICAL misses at all**
- Your assessment result decides where you start.
    - **Pass video 1:** you pass!
        - 95% or higher (with no more than 1 critical miss): you skip probation and start as an independent reviewer.
        - 80% to under 95%: you start as a reviewer on probation.
    - **Don't pass video 1** (below 80%, or 2 or more critical misses): take quiz 2.
    - **Pass video 2** (80% or higher, no critical miss): you pass! You start as a reviewer on probation.
    - **Don't pass video 2:** you do not pass.
- After each clip, the quiz shows your score, how many critical misses you had, and the maximum allowed. If you don't pass, the final result tells you which requirement you missed.
- If you don't pass either video, you won't be onboarded as a reviewer on Project Odin.
        - To offboard from Project Odin:
            - Open Maven on your Mercor dashboard.
            - Ask: "Please send me the link to offboard from Project Odin."
            - Open the offboarding link and complete the steps.
        - If Maven doesn't provide a link or directs you back to the project team, contact your project point of contact in Odin Slack or email support@mercor.com.
- **Probation:** QC audits your first reviews before you can review independently.
    - Your **first 2 reviews of any kind** (approvals and send-backs) are audited **as a pair**.
    - You can complete **at most 4 reviews** while waiting to receive audit feedback.

    - **If both reviews pass the audit:** finish probation and become an independent reviewer.
    - **If both reviews fail the audit:** you will be offboarded as a reviewer (non-MacBook experts) or return to being a writer
    - **One pass and one fail:** try another pair (up to 2). You get **up to 2 chances** before being offboarded as a reviewer or moving back to being a writer.
- **Independent reviewer:** you review without the probation cap or paired audits.
    - QC still audits a sample of your approvals and send-backs, so **follow the Reviewer Checklist on every task**.
    - You move back to writer if QC finds either:
        - **3 or more defects in your latest 10 audited reviews**
        - **2 or more defects before your first 10 audited reviews**.

Claiming and completing reviews

- Finish each review in one sitting where possible. Studio returns review and QC claims to the queue after 3 hours without saved activity. This is an inactivity timeout, not an AHT target or a limit on time worked.
    - If you need more time, **check in with an EPM**, then select **Extend Review Claim** on the right of the task page.
- **Complete the entire review even if you know early that it's a send-back.** Complete the checklist thoroughly so the writer can fix it all in one pass.

Send-backs and rejections

- **Complexity send-backs are for Review 1 only.** On a resubmission, do not reject (Core world) or send back (Full Production world) for complexity. If the task is otherwise approvable, approve it and note in **Internal Notes** that you believe it doesn't meet the complexity requirements.
    - If the Reviewer raised the complexity issue in R1 and the writer didn't fix it, then R2 can send back.
- **Restricted apps in tasks already in flight:**
    - **In review, and Pages in the setup (or other restricted app) is the only issue:** Pause the review, add internal note and note the task ID in the restricted-app tracking sheet. Do not reject and do not approve the task if Pages in the setup **(or other restricted app)** is the only issue. Leave the task as it is. **Contact an EPM.**
    - **Task idea approved with a restricted app but not recorded yet:** Ask the writer to change the app, and update the change for writers.(Changing the app is only possible in the Full Production world)
    - **In review, with other issues and a restricted app:** Send the task back for revisions (Full Production world) or reject it (Core world) and ask the writer to replace the restricted app.
    - **Already approved:** Note the task ID.

    - **Already rejected:** No action needed.

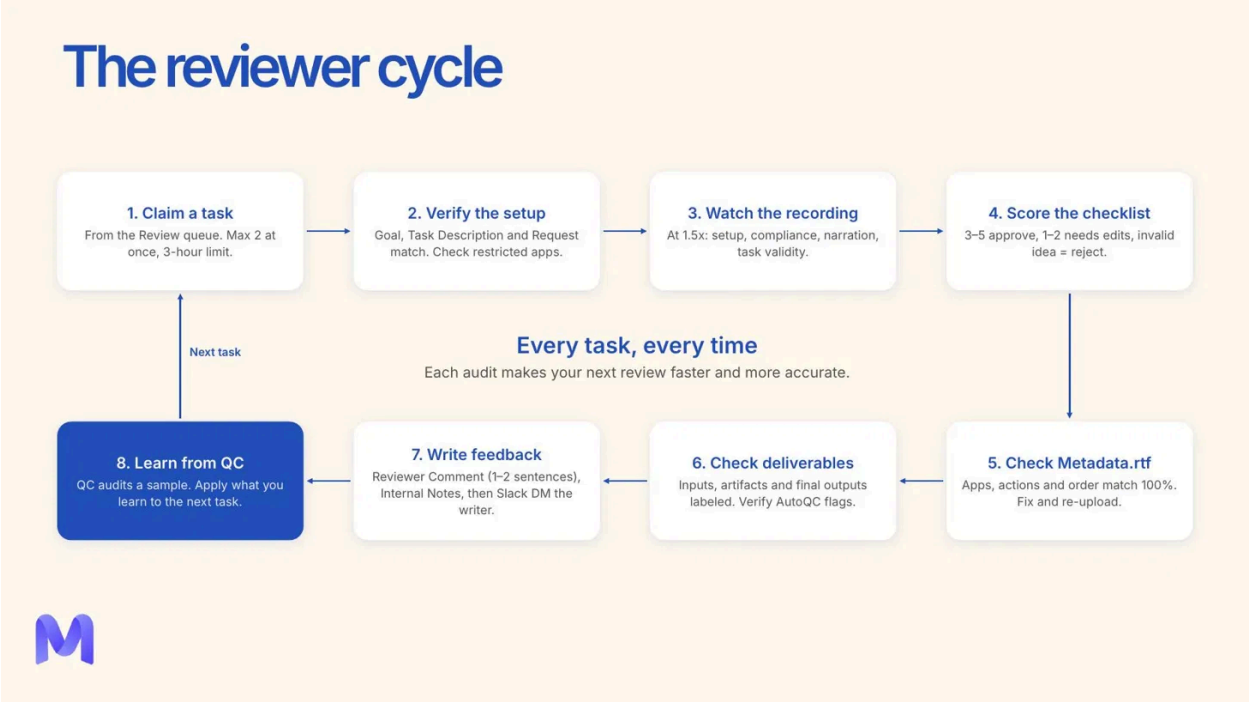
Reviewer Expectations

These expectations apply to **all reviewers**. Your metrics inform your reviewer status, including promotion and demotion. **You are responsible for maintaining these metrics.**

- **Audit defect rate: under 10%**
    - Fewer than 10% of your audited reviews (approvals and send-backs) should have QC defects.
    - **Follow the Reviewer Checklist on every task** to keep your defect rate low.
- **Review pass rate: 30% or higher**
    - At least 30% of the tasks you review should be approved by you.
    - **20% to under 30%:** this is a warning for now.
    - **Help train writers up:** give clear, specific feedback in your Reviewer Comments and Slack DM so writers can fix every issue in one pass and improve on their next task.
- **Review AHT: an average, not a per-review limit**
    - Aim for an average of 60 minutes or less per completed review through Sunday, October 18, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. PT. From Monday, October 19, 2026 at 12:00 a.m. PT, aim for under 45 minutes. Individual reviews can take longer when needed. Follow-ups start on October 18, 2026, using the 60-minute-or-less reviewer average target that day.
    - Reviewer AHT policy assessment uses the last seven complete Pacific calendar days (America/Los_Angeles), ending at midnight PT at the start of today and advancing daily. Calculate AHT as (eligible logged reviewer hours in that window × 60) ÷ completed review decisions in the same window. Pool hours and decisions across all seven days; do not average daily AHTs. Dashboard display/report filters do not change the policy assessment window.
    - Keep quality and precision while you reduce your AHT.
- **Hours per week: 15 hours**
    - Plan to spend 15 hours per week on reviews.

Review Process

[Review Setup](#)
- [Live List of Restricted Apps](#)
- [Metadata.rtf Check](#)
- [Video Review](#)
- [Post-Video Review](#)



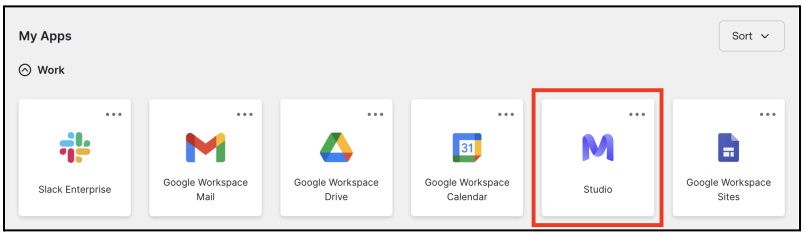
How to use this document

Read through this document from start to finish to understand the entire review process. Use it as a reference during your initial reviews to build strong habits and attention to detail. As you become more comfortable with the workflow, work to decrease your average handling time (AHT) while maintaining quality and precision.

Review Setup

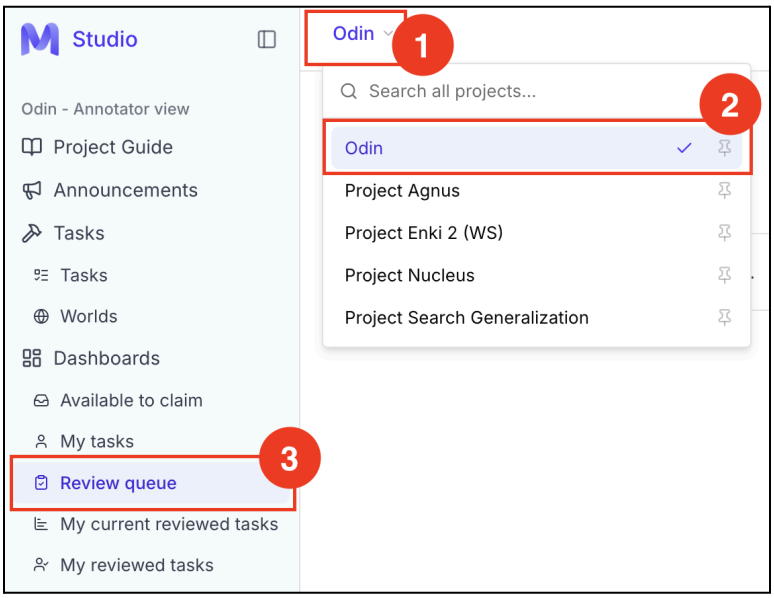
1. Claim a Task

- Access Studio through Okta



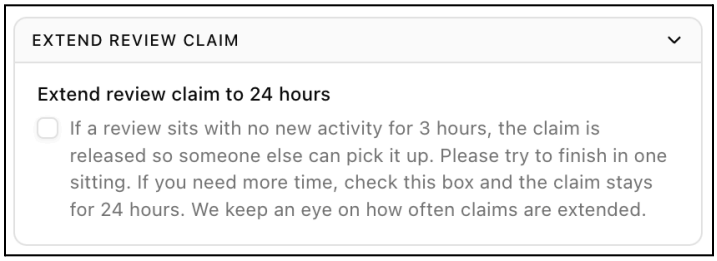
Do not use VPN - Sign-ins to Okta through a VPN, proxy, or other anonymizing network are blocked and show a 403 Access Forbidden error before the sign-in page loads. Turn off any VPN (system-wide app or browser extension) before starting the Okta setup and whenever you sign in to Okta. See the Account Security and Conduct policy.

- In Studio, click the **Project Selector** at the top, and select the Project Odin Studio space. Then, from the left-side navigation menu, under **Dashboards**, select **Review queue**



- Select and then claim a task; prioritize (click on the column header to sort):
  - First submission
  - Longest time in the queue
- You can also set the **Filter** to see tasks currently awaiting review.
- **Do not have more than 2 reviews claimed at a time.**
- **3-hour auto-unclaim rule:**
  - Please try to finish your review in one sitting.

- Studio returns stale review/QC claims to the queue after 3 hours without saved activity. This is an inactivity timeout, separate from AHT and from time worked.
    - If you need an extension, **please check in with one of the EPMs** and then select **the Extend Review Claim** box on the right of the task page.



Restricted vs. Allowed Apps

Restricted apps in existing recordings: Complete the review. If a restricted app is the only issue, including in the opening Goal document, do not approve or reject the task. Add an Internal Note explaining the app and its use, add the task ID to the restricted-app tracking sheet, unclaim the task, and contact an EPM for a decision. If other issues require revisions or rejection, follow the existing send-back rules and ask the writer to replace the restricted app.

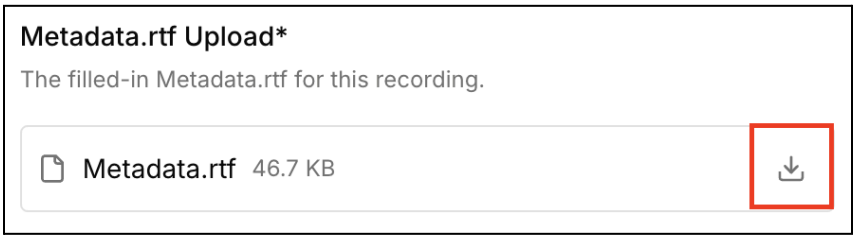
App eligibility: The approved-app requirement is retired. Unrestricted apps may be used without prior approval. Do not fail or hold a task solely because its app is unlisted or lacks prior app approval. Follow the canonical three-category app list at https://odin-mercor1.vercel.app/validated-apps. It governs when older Studio labels or copied tables disagree. Project operating rule: minimal use means less than 20% of the task. Workpuls/Insightful and Splashtop Streamer remain background-only, and app-specific supporting-use limits still apply. Apply the 2026-10-16 18:08 PDT cutoff and in-flight protection stated there; now-allowed app rejections may be reconsidered subject to other quality checks. Notes remain allowed but discouraged for genuine task work and must not be used for the opening Goal document. The table below is historical; check the current category for each app.

What to verify

- These must match each other exactly:
    - Goal in the Studio Prompt/Description
    - Task Description in the TaskRecorder window and metadata.json
    - TaskRecorder 2.4.4 requires no sign-in, so its metadata.json google_account field may be empty.
    - Request section in metadata.rtf
- Writers and reviewers can't edit the Prompt/Description field.
- **If the recording differs from the Task Description or the app listed in metadata.json/Studio** (for example, the writer changed apps mid-task) and the task is otherwise approvable, note the discrepancy in **Internal Notes** and approve the task. This allowance does not authorize a restricted app; apply the restricted-app hold rule above.
- An approved idea creates the task automatically, so you don't need to check whether the idea was approved first. If you don't see an Approval ID in the Prompt/Description field, **check with an EPM**.
- To get live captions on recordings (Chrome only):
    - Click the ... in the top right of Chrome and select Settings.
    - On the left sidebar, select Accessibility.
    - Turn on Live Caption and make sure the language is English.
    - In Studio, click the download button on the recording to open it in a new tab. Captions appear during playback.
        - See the Slack thread for screenshots.

Metadata.rtf Check

- Click and download the **Metadata.rtf** from the **Task files** section in Studio



- Once it's downloaded and saved to your computer, click and open it in TextEdit.app
    - Open it in any text editor (TextEdit on Mac; WordPad or Word on Windows). Keep the file in .rtf format.
- As you review, pull up the task's **Metadata.rtf file** and make sure that the apps, actions, and chronology sync up 100% to the recording and the Task Description. If they do not match → Reviewer makes edits and re-uploads

****These must be 100% accurate for the task to be accepted.****
Reviewers are expected to edit/correct any mistakes.

Topology

- Topology is a high-level overview of the chronological sequence/workflow shown in the recording
- There are ONLY 3 categories allowed in ***topology:***
    - **1.**LOOKUP **2.**CREATE **3.**MODIFY
- Apps can be repeated in the flow if they are used more than once
    - Examples:
        - Finder (LOOKUP) -> Note (CREATE) -> Chrome (LOOKUP) -> LibreOffice Impress (CREATE) →> Chrome (LOOKUP) -> LibreOffice Impress (MODIFY)
        - Safari (LOOKUP) -> Microsoft Excel (CREATE) -> GraphPad Prism (CREATE)

Request

- Should be the same as the **Goal** section in the **Prompt/Description**.
    - For example: I've approved the talking points for next week's meeting. Go ahead and make a slide deck that highlights the pros and cons of opening a restaurant in Midwest City, Oklahoma. Make sure to include demographic data and actual photos of the area — not stock images.

Task Description

- Provide a numbered, step-by-step outline of how you will complete the task.

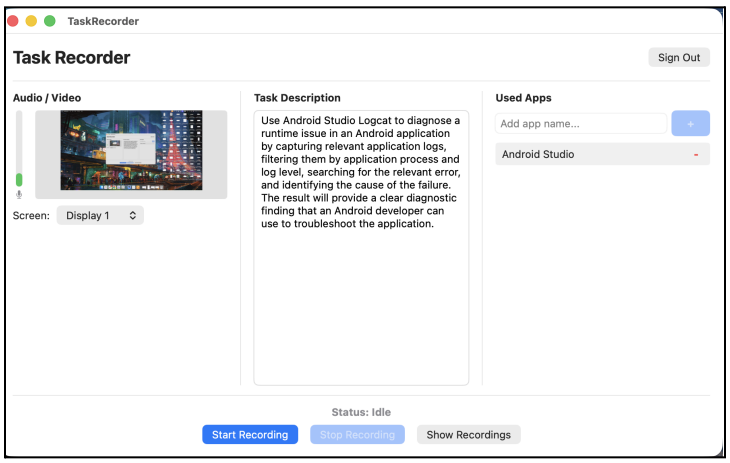
Video Review

- Reviewer acceptance: the total recording, including the short intro and epilogue, must be at least 15 minutes and no more than 54 minutes and 59 seconds (15:00-54:59). Writer guidance remains 15:00 to 50:59. Do not reject or request re-recording solely because a video is over 50:59 but no more than 54:59; all other quality requirements still apply.
- A single-app task is acceptable; there is no minimum app count. Using multiple apps is encouraged when each contributes substantively and meaningfully to the task.
    - Every task, regardless of app count, must reflect a realistic professional workflow within the domain of expertise, demonstrate meaningful skill and judgment, and result in a clear deliverable.

Note: *Recordings should be reviewed at x1.5 speed.*

Setup/Intro Review

- Recording starts with the **TaskRecorder** window shown.
    - If the TaskRecorder window is not shown at the beginning of the recording, this might be a TR bug → **Review as normal and include in the internal notes**
    - **TaskRecorder** window minimized at the beginning of recording, and never shown during the recording outside start/stop flow.
- **Task Description** and **Used Apps** are already filled out in the TaskRecorder screen at the beginning of the recording, and the description matches the Studio (Goal section) and the Task Description document (Goal section).



- **Menu bar & Dock:**
    - **Menu bar:** the clock on the menu bar should display seconds (HH:MM:SS).
    - **Dock:** Visible at least at the beginning and the end of recording, with the **Accessibility Inspector** opened in the dock with a dot at the bottom.
        - Dock at the bottom of the screen → **BANNED, Request Edits**
        - Dock at the left/right of the screen → **preferred**

- **UI Diversity:**
    - **At least one element must be changed to create a diverse desktop environment (this does not include dock position):**
        - dark vs light mode
        - colors
        - resolutions
        - wallpaper
        - size of icon
        - theme
    - Mouse cursor size and color must stay default.

Intro Steps

1. Desktop setup (opening apps, changing UI elements, etc.) and draft the task description document
2. Minimize all apps to the dock
3. Leave the task description document open on screen
4. Open the TR window and click **Start Recording**
5. Minimizing TR window
6. Narrate “I will be beginning my task soon. Here is the workflow I have in mind.”
7. Wait a few seconds
8. Minimize task description
9. This marks the start of the task

Task Review

- The video demonstrates **domain expertise**.
    - **Domain Expertise:** We expect workflows that show knowledge relevant to the industry for each task. We want **unique** and **complex** tasks.
        - Expertise can also be demonstrated through **insightful narration explaining the “why”**. A task with a simple, basic UI workflow is still only valid if the app requested by the client is simple and basic in nature. A task should be approved if the writer’s narration clearly demonstrates expert-level knowledge of the subject matter
        - The final deliverable should look like a typical industry output, with good spelling and grammar. If the deliverable is code, it must function as intended.
            1. Some apps have limitations, and domain expertise shows in the creation rather than the output. For apps that contain these limitations, a screenshot or other mode of output is acceptable. **The task as a whole should still demonstrate domain expertise.**
- **App usage:**

    - A single-app task is acceptable. Do not request extra apps solely to reach an app count. Assess the professional workflow, skill, judgment, and deliverable requirements above.
    - Apps used during the tasks must match those listed in Studio.
    - Do not list the browser when it's only used to open web apps (e.g., Google Docs in Opera). List the web apps themselves. A browser is listed only when it's used as an app in its own right.
    - All listed apps need to provide meaningful contribution to the deliverable; meaningful work must be performed in all of the apps.
        - **For example:** If copying text from GDoc to Pages, this is not meaningful.
    - The notes app used in setup should not be listed in the AT unless used during the task.
- **AI Use:**
    - No AI tool or AI Mode interaction in the task is allowed
        - Use AI-generated input files → **Allowed**
        - Interacting with any type of AI or using AI to generate content during recording → **Not Allowed**
        - **Google interaction:**
            1. Looking at AI Overview search results or clicking **Show more** → **Allowed**
            2. **Interacting/communicating/chatting** with **Ask Anything** (for instance, asking a prompt in Ask Anything) → **Not Allowed**
        - Passive enhancement / ordinary built-in functionality → **Allowed**
- **PII & Copyrights:**
    - No personal accounts used or personal information shown.
    - No reference to Project Odin, Mercor, or TaskRecorder. Exceptions: taskrecorder.dmg and TR recording folders/files - remind writer to eject/clean the drive; no need to reject solely for this reason.
    - Only use CC0/Public Domain images and files.
    - Input files should also be PII-free, royalty-free, and have no copyright information (CC0).
    - See the PII and Royalty-free Issues page for more details.
- **Mouse movement:**
    - The mouse should be continuously moving most of the time.
        - Typing doesn't count as mouse movement; the cursor should not be idle for >45s in an instance outside the closing epilogue. The epilogue may be still. AutoQC excludes the final 5 minutes from its mouse-idle check; this technical buffer does not increase the 4-minute epilogue maximum.
    - Most actions should use the mouse rather than the keyboard, except for coding tasks and Content and Writing domains where typing can make up about 30% of the total recording time. For other domains, typing needs to be <20%.
    - Clicks should be deliberate and unrushed.
- **Audio: See detailed instructions on Audio Guidance here**

- **Narration** should be from the Intro through the end of the recording.
    - Natural, clear, and aligned narration of actions and thought process.
    - No major pauses.
    - **Narration cadence, workflow actions, and interactions** should not be rushed.
    - Must follow the What, Where, Why criteria.
        1. No **"this", "that", or "here".**
            - ❌ Bad Examples:
                - I'll click on this button
                - I need to change that value.
            - ✅ Good Examples:
                - I'll click the blue Export button in the top right corner.
                - I need to change the font size, which is currently set to 12.
- **Background Noise** is minimal. Background noise that obscures narration for more than roughly 30% of the video is unacceptable.

- **Window Management:**
    - Writers should use the available screen space effectively. When possible, maximize application windows or arrange them side by side.
    - Writers should work to cover the desktop background. Small floating windows are not preferred.
    - **Side-by-side** window arrangement is encouraged
    - If more than **~25% of a window or application** is covered by other windows/apps, it should be minimized within 6 seconds.
        - ***Exception:*** *Slight delays are allowed if the writer clearly notices the overlap immediately and makes a dedicated, immediate effort to fix it (e.g. they are narrating while minimizing the window or moving the mouse slowly).*
    - Windows important for the task and the current sub-task can remain un-minimized if they are clearly visible and logically arranged.
    - **In-app Popups:** Windows that are built into the UI of the application and cannot be moved or resized → **OK**

- Filling out **Metadata.rtf** should **NOT** be shown in recording

- **English is required as the primary language.** Narration, deliverables, webpages, and app menus must all be in English

- **NEW - Epilogue narration (ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026, 6PM PT)**

- For Full Workflow, ideas originally approved before October 19, 2026, 6 pm PT (PDT) remain exempt from the epilogue, including after later revision or reapproval. Writers still tick the epilogue checkbox to confirm either a completed required epilogue or the pre-cutoff exemption; they must not tick it if neither condition is true. Do not reject or require re-recording solely for a missing epilogue on an exempt task. This manual checkbox is separate from AutoQC: assess written disputes using the task and relevant timestamps. If submission remains blocked, ask the writer to send the task link and exact error to #odin--helpdesk. After the task is finished and before the writer closes the task recorder, they must provide a brief summary of their work (target: 3-4 minutes; maximum: 4:00; no 3-minute minimum), an assessment of whether the task was completed, any relevant reflections, or other important highlights: Possible topics include:
    - **Completion and outcome:** How did you verify the successful completion of the task? Were there any limitations?
    - **Approach and key decision:** What was your overall approach? Why did you choose this approach?
    - **Challenges and problem solving:** What was the most difficult, ambiguous, or unexpected part? Did you encounter any errors or need to change your approach? How did you resolve the issue?
    - **Quality assessment:** How would you evaluate the quality of your final result? Ar there any weaknesses or potential issues with the result?
    - **Reflection and improvement**: If you were to do the task again, what would you do differently? If you had additional time, what would you improve or verify?
    - **Insight:** What is one important principle, consideration, or common mistake that someone less experienced might overlook when performing this type of task?
    - **<u>Mouse is permitted to remain idle during the epilogue narration</u>**

Post-Video Review

- **Download and verify deliverable.zip files match the recording:**
    - Everything below needs to be included in the deliverable.zip:
        - **Input File:** Any original starting files prepared in advance(e.g., file, image, etc.); the original and unedited files are clearly labeled using the format: 'input 1', 'input 2', etc.
        - Websites the writer only visits for research or context (e.g., reading documentation, looking up reference data) are not input files. Don't fail a task for not including them in deliverable.zip or Final Notes.
        - **Intermediate Artifacts:** Any files downloaded during recording, intermediate deliverables, or work-in-progress artifacts created during the task must be clearly labeled using the format: 'artifact 1', 'artifact 2', etc.
        - **Final Output:** The final product produced by the expert, clearly labeled as 'final output 1', 'final output 2', etc.
    - **Example:** If a writer prepared a photo in advance, edited the photo using PhotoPea, and added the photo to create a slide, they will include the following in the deliverable.zip:
        - Unedited/original photo → input 1
        - Edited photo → artifact 1
        - Slide → final output 1
- **Rate the writer** using the Reviewer Checklist.
- **Update Studio fields if needed:**
    - **If you need to change a task field,** explain what needs to be changed and why. Include this in the **Reviewer Comments** and as an **Internal Note**.
- **Add Internal Notes**: *These are notes that the writers will not see. They are for QC and EPMs only.*
    - Add anything that you want to pass to QC, any minor issues that you find which do not affect approval, and/or any strengths in the task that override the minor issues. Pro tip: If you find yourself making a judgment call on an edge case, explain your reasoning for approving the task in the Internal Notes.
- **Add Reviewer Comments:** *These are notes that are writer-facing and should reflect the DM that you send them.*
    - Please use this template at the top of every review. Always put your most recent review of the task at the top.
        - MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #_____, REVIEWER NAME

*Decide if the Task is **Approved** or **Request Edits***

Approve: If a 3-5 is selected for a task, it is approved.

- 4-5 = Approvable as submitted (No 3s or 4s)
    - Excellent = Approvable as submitted (No 3s or 4s)
    - Good, but writer needs some tips = Lower quality, but likely useful (a couple of 3, but no 4s)
- 3 = Lower quality, but likely useful (No 4s)
    - Edge Case = Some 2s and 3s but no 4's.

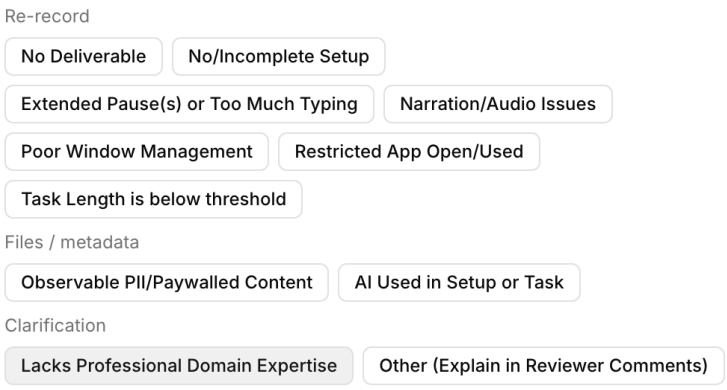
Needs Edits: If a 1-2 is selected, it is sent back to the writer for revisions.

- 2 = Needs revisions
    - Fair = Mostly 3s and at least one 4; Needs Revision.
- 1 = Needs revisions, task not salvageable
    - Poor = Mostly 3s and 4s, Needs Revision.

QUALITY CLARIFICATION: DO NOT send tasks back solely because pauses after clicks are shorter than one second. The exact threshold is under review. Continue assessing pacing and followability using the existing review standards.

Needs edit reason

If the task is being sent back for revisions, you will be asked to select every reason from the following reasons why:



Feedback field

IMPORTANT!

At the very end, send a Slack DM of your feedback to the Writer. Use the DM Templates for each flag in the task.

These are visible to the writer and should be identical to the DM that you send them after you complete the review of the task.

- Begin each review comment with:
    - Review [#]: [MM/DD/YYY] @ [HH:MM TIMEZONE] Reviewer: [Name]

Always add the most recent comment at the top.

The goal for reviewers is to leave no more than 1-2 sentences of personalized feedback to writers, regardless of whether the task is failed or approved. Please take this opportunity to advise writers on how to improve, provide encouragement, or congratulate them on submitting great work.

Reviewer Checklist

Below is the Project Odin Reviewer checklist that will be used to verify the quality of tasks on Project Odin. When reviewing a task, you will be selecting which tolerance criteria have been met for each checklist item, which is on the following scale:

- 1 = Within client tolerance
- 2 = Within acceptable tolerance
- 3 = Within edge case tolerance
- 4 = Failing tolerance

Some checklist items have binary tolerance criteria - they either fulfilled it (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (4 = No). Other checklist items have a range which will be described within each checklist item.

Checklist item	**Criteria**			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
1. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow)	Yes	Metadata.rtf >80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal and to Studio	Metadata.rtf >70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal and to Studio	Metadata.rtf <70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or to Studio
2. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s	Yes	An unused window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for 6–30 s	N/A	An unused window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for >30 s with no clear effort to fix within time
3. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Narration says what, where and why for every action	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws (an action is anything that changes the

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
				state of the document)
4. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Eyes closed test: Viewer clearly understands what actions are being performed in the video with eyes closed (no 'click here', 'change this')	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws
5. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
6. [Manual] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
7. [Manual] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
8. [Manual] Keep the intro under 20 seconds: say the intro sentence, minimize the Goal document, start.	Yes	21-60 s	N/A	>60s
9. [Manual] Filling out Metadata.rtf is not shown in the recording.	Yes	No, filling out Metadata.rtf shown for 10 s or less		No, filling out Metadata.rtf shown for >10 s
10. [Manual] Typing takes up 20% of the video or less (up to about 30% for coding and content & writing tasks).	Yes	No, typing takes up <25% of the video (<30% for coding and content & writing)	N/A	No, typing takes up ≥25% of the video (≥30% for coding and content & writing)
11. [Manual] Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.	Yes	46–60 s	N/A	Over 60 s

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
12. [Manual] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)	Yes	No, background noise 30–40% of the narration	N/A	No, background noise over 40% of the narration
13. [Manual] The TaskRecorder window only appears when starting or stopping the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
14. [Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click (i.e. they don't click too fast)	Yes	No, missing in 1-6 segments	No, missing in 6-12 segments	No, the writer consistently clicks too fast
15. [Manual] The recording is free of AI use. (Allowed: AI features part of an app's normal tools)	Yes	No, Google AI Overview (no follow-ups), autocomplete, SWE/ML	N/A	No, AI interaction present
16. [Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
17. [Manual] The recording is free of paywalled or copyrighted content.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
18. [Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	No, minor profanity on screen, not typed by the writer	N/A	No, profanity said or typed by the writer, or more than minor on-screen profanity
19. [Manual] Task is	Yes	N/A	N/A	No/Cannot

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
recorded in English and all task materials are in English				verify
20. [Manual] Recording includes an epilogue narration (a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges, quality, and reflections) of 4 minutes or less, before stopping recording (only for ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT). Target 3-4 minutes with no 3-minute minimum. All duration bands over 4:00 exceed the maximum; they record severity, not an allowance for extra duration.	Yes	No, narration length is between 4:01-4:30 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	No, the narration lacked detail / length is between 4:31-5:00 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	N/A
21. [Manual] The task contains sufficient complexity / domain expertise (e.g., multi-step workflow, domain judgement, use of multiple tools, output that would be produced for real work)	Yes	A non-expert can do <10% of actions	N/A	No, a non-expert can do >10% of the actions

AutoQC checks of task elements (for reference purpose):

1. All four task files uploaded (MP4, deliverables.zip, Task Recorder zip, Metadata.rtf)
2. Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present
3. video.mp4 opens
4. Deliverables named correctly
5. Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, OTA, workflow)
6. Video length within 15 to 54:59 minutes
7. Dock stays visible (not covered) in the start and end of recording
8. No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s
    a. **Major flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for >30s
    b. **Minor flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for 6-30s
9. Mouse never idle >45 s
    a. **Major flag:** Mouse idle for >60s
    b. **Minor flag:** Mouse idle for ≥3 stretches within 45–60s
10. Narration says what, where and why for every action
11. Narration names what and where, no 'click here' / 'change this'
12. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task
13. Metadata.rtf apps match the apps listed in Studio
14. Dock is not positioned at the bottom of the screen
15. Accessibility Inspector icon is visible in the Dock with a dot underneath
16. Accessibility Inspector window is not visible during the recording (exception: first-time writers)
17. At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup
18. Typing is at most 20% of video length (coding and content & writing exception: up to ~30%)
19. The task contains zero use of restricted apps
20. Narration cadence and workflow interactions are followable at normal speed

PII and Copyright Issues

No PII (Personally Identifiable Information) should be visible during the recording of the task, including in any of the input files:

Any information that can identify a real person, such as:

- Writer's full names
- email addresses
- phone numbers
- home addresses
- account numbers
- biometrics
- Mac Address
- etc.

Edge cases:

- If the full name is of a public figure → **OK**
- If the full name is not combined with any other information that can increase the specificity → **OK**
    - Sandy Jones (alone) → **OK**
    - sandyjones@walmart.com → **PII** (identifies a person + company)
    - sandyjones@example.com → **Not PII** (example domain / not meaningfully identifying)
- If the name/email/phone number is obviously made up and fake, e.g. John Smith or johnsmith@example.com or 123-456-7890 → **OK**
- Full names from OTAs → **OK**
- IP addresses → **OK**
- Mac Serial Number (found in the *Hardware Overview* page in *System Information.app*):
    - Standalone MAC serial numbers → **OK**
    - MAC serial number **PLUS** IPV6 → **PII**
- If you are unsure whether something is a PII issue, post in #odin--reviewers.

OTA emails, mercor.expert, or obviously fake name/email/phone numbers are allowed.

Ideally, project information is also hidden, including references to:

- **Mercor**
- **Project Odin**
- **Project Odin Writer Guidelines**
- **Studio instructions**

This will be tolerated in small quantities and should not lead to task rejection on its own.

EXCEPTIONS: Public profiles such as authors of publications or GitHub users from public GitHub repositories do not count as PII.

SWE/ML/DS tracks: Public Repositories Exception: Currently, the exception to the rule is for tasks involving gitflow, where the task involves pulling repositories from GitHub. Despite this, only public repositories are allowed; even then, steer toward repositories with MIT, BSD, Apache 2.0, CC0, public domain, ODC-by, or PDDL licenses, as these licenses are widely considered compliant under copyright laws. Licenses are typically found in the repository root or in README.md, under names like LICENSE.md/LICENSE.txt or COPYING.txt.

CC0/Public Domain Only: If the task requires downloading images, videos, or assets, ensure they are under CC0 license or in the Public Domain.

This only applies to information that ends up in the Deliverable.zip. Browsing a website with a trademarked logo is acceptable.

- **Copyright:** a clear watermark (**exception: Gemini watermark**) or copyright logo → reject, unless it is CC0. Escalate to EPM if unsure.

Note: Please do not recommend a website to a writer unless you are 100% certain its content is under CC0 or its Terms & Conditions allow AI/ML training.

Search & AI (and how to distinguish cases):

- Google Search only, including links in the AI overview, even in "Show more," but **no** interaction with AI Overview "Ask anything", **is allowed.**
- Generative/conversational AI → **Request Edits**.
  - Any prompting, chatting, follow-up question, AI Mode, Gemini/ChatGPT/Claude use, Google AI Overview "Ask anything," or AI-generated task content during setup/task recording is not allowed.
- AI-powered task tools → **Request Edits.**
  - If an app feature uses AI/ML to perform substantive task work, such as identifying a subject, selecting/masking an object, generating text/images, summarizing, classifying, etc, request edits.
  - Example: Photoshop subject identification used to create/edit the deliverable.
- Passive enhancement / ordinary built-in functionality → **Escalate if unclear; may be acceptable**.
  - If the feature is not presented as AI, involves no prompting/generative AI, and only performs incidental quality cleanup rather than substantive task work, it may be acceptable.
  - Example: Voice Memos Enhance Recording was treated as an edge-case exception when no AI agent interaction occurred, and the task was otherwise strong. Escalate similar cases before rejecting.
- SWE/ML/AI exceptions → **Acceptable/Escalate if unclear**

- For SWE tasks, writers may use code that includes an AI/ML component (such as building foundation models). Running the code may be acceptable **only if** it is part of normal SWE validation and not being used as an external assistant to complete the task.
- Escalate ambiguous cases.

Audio-specific Guidance

Narration must include thought process and actions (i.e., mouse movements, clicks, and scrolling, step by step)

Pacing and Audio Quality

- **Avoid Rushing** - Ensure all clicks and actions are narrated at a deliberate, measured pace. Workflows and mouse interactions should be in sync with narration. Rule of thumb: if you need to slow the video down to .75x speed, or pause and rewind for more than 30% of the recording, it is rushed.
- **Audio Environment** - Ensure there is no background noise when recording audio. Ideally, use headphones with a dedicated microphone when available to maintain clear audio quality.
- **Pause After Clicks** - Experts should wait 1 second after clicking on something.

Narration is trying to meet 3 criteria:

1. **What** - What physical action produces the interaction (scroll, right-click, left-click)?
2. **Where** - Where on the screen does the interaction take place (top left, bottom right, left panel)?
3. **Why** - Why is this interaction important? What does the interaction do (closes the app, saves the doc, etc.)?

Common Pitfalls:

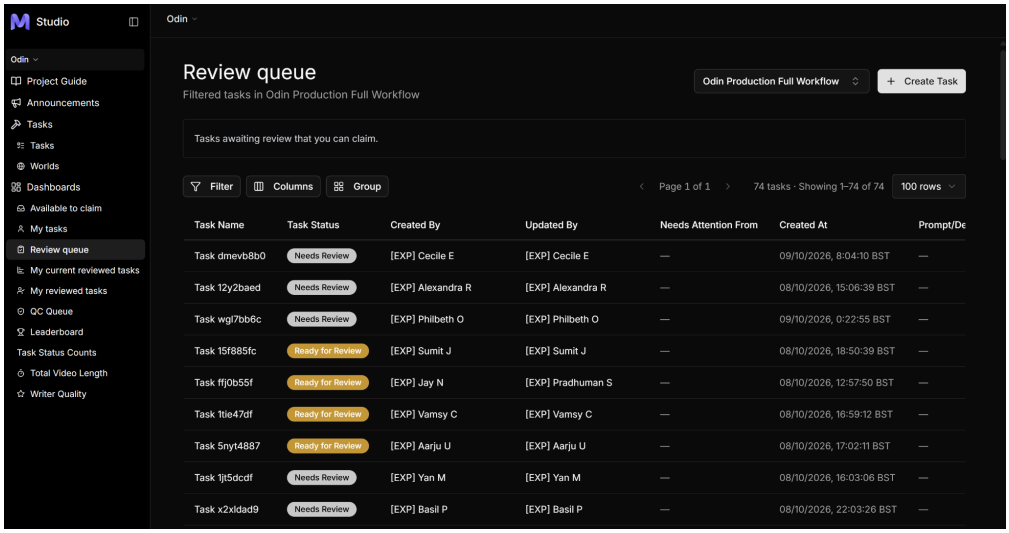
- Failing to narrate each major step of a workflow as it happens.
- Long introduction
- Long gaps without audio.
- No narration of shortcuts. All shortcuts used must provide keystrokes and resulting action.
- Narration that is difficult to hear/understand.
- Noise or audio distractions interfere with intelligibility.
- Referencing the task description verbatim. The task should be described naturally, as it happens.
- Golden narration is clear, concise, coherent, easy to understand, logically structured, and directly supports the steps being shown, while still allowing for a natural speaking style, such as natural pauses or conversational fillers.
- Note: Natural conversational fillers like “uh” or “um” are acceptable; the goal is simply to avoid extended, off-topic tangents.

Studio Idea review

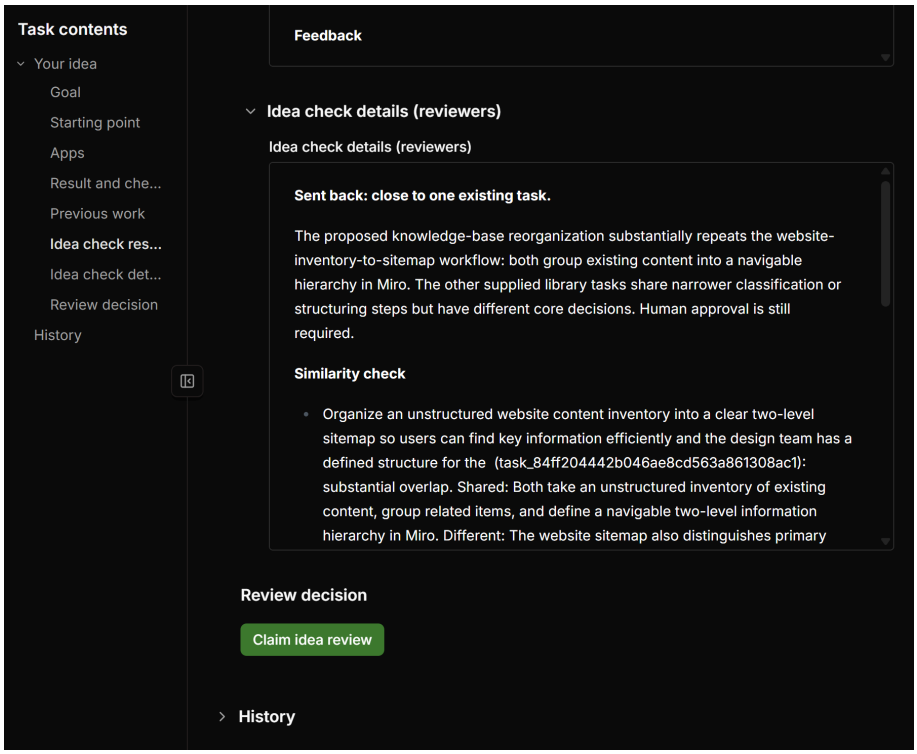
- Idea review is separate from task (recording) review.
- Idea reviews happen in Studio, in the **Odin Production Full Workflow** world.
- Idea checks are mostly automated. Distinct ideas are approved automatically so the writer can start recording.
- Ideas the model can't verify appear as **Needs Review** in the review queue.

  Watch a walkthrough video:
  https://mercor.enterprise.slack.com/files/U0AEX1WLK88/F0C815XMYG5/video.mp4

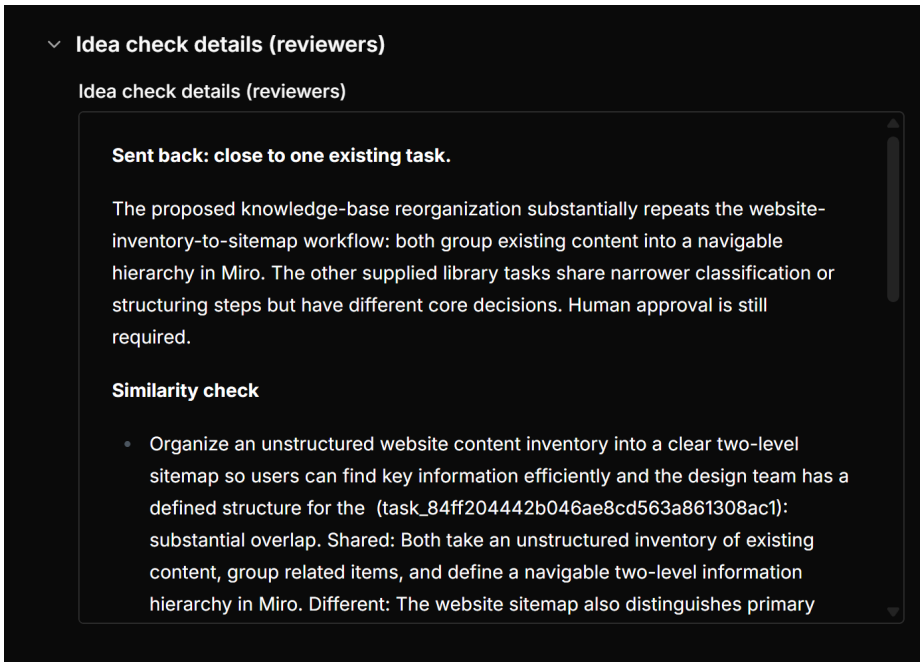
1. Head to the Review Queue in Studio and check if you have selected the **Odin Production Full Workflow** world in there.



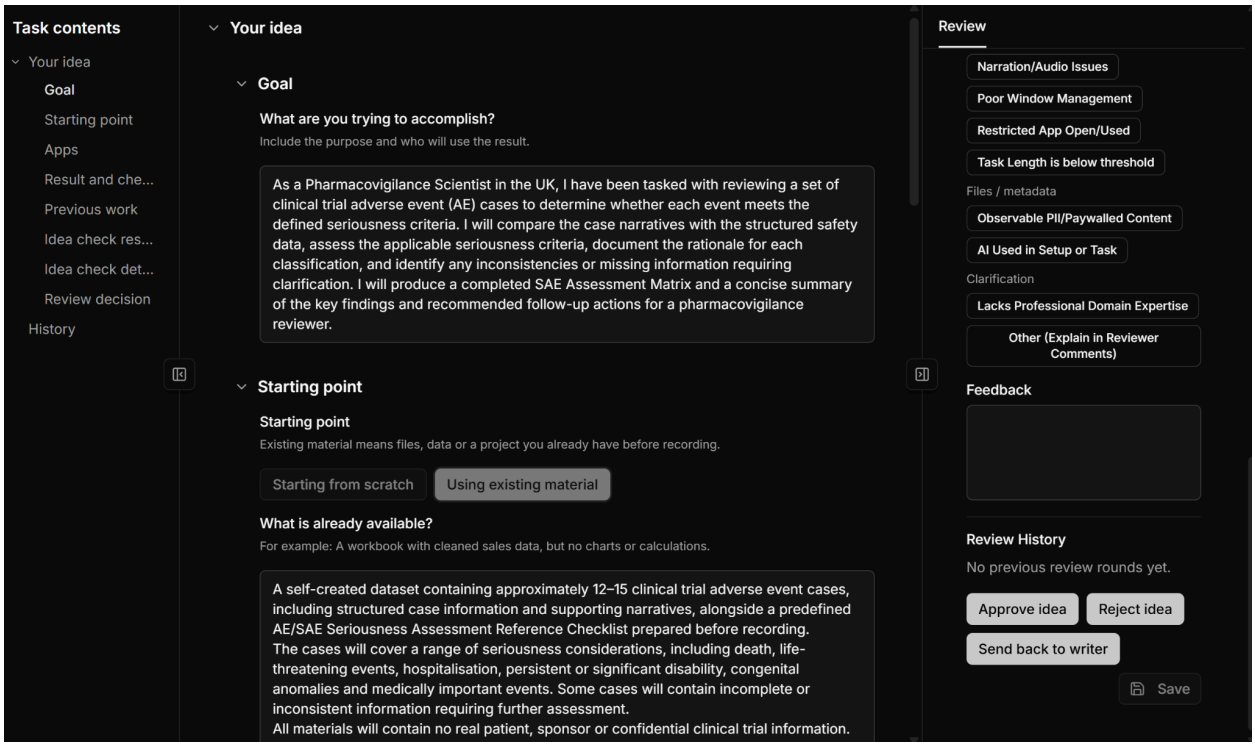
2. Look for the Task Status **‘Needs Review’**. Open the idea>claim idea review and skim-read through the goal, starting point, suggested apps, and reviews and checks.



3. Read through the results generated in the **Idea check details (reviewers)** section to compare the model’s findings to similar tasks in the project and check the same against the guidelines provided here**.**



4. Please complete the Idea review by adding your decision to the ‘Review’ panel to the left. Add feedback and either **Approve, Reject, or Send back to the Writer**.



QC auditor guidelines

Before you start

- Bookmark the QC Resources canvas. It has every link you need in one place.

Claiming and completing QC

- Finish each QC in one sitting where possible. Studio returns review and QC claims to the queue after 3 hours without saved activity. This is an inactivity timeout, not a QC AHT target or a limit on time worked. The QC AHT target is under 45 minutes on average per completed QC. Individual QCs can take longer when needed.
- QC AHT policy assessment uses the last seven complete Pacific calendar days (America/Los_Angeles), ending at midnight PT at the start of today and advancing daily. Calculate AHT as (eligible logged QC hours in that window × 60) ÷ completed QC decisions in the same window. Pool hours and decisions across all seven days; do not average daily AHTs. Dashboard display/report filters do not change the policy assessment window.
    - If you need more time, **check in with an EPM**, then select **Extend Review Claim** on the right of the task page.
- **Watch the full recording**, and judge followability at normal (1x) speed.
- **Complete the entire QC even if you know early that it's a send-back.** Complete the checklist thoroughly so the writer can fix it all in one pass.
- Leave feedback for the writer on every task, whether it is approved or sent back

What to check for reviewers

Along with the task itself, look over the reviewer's work.

- The reviewer completed every item on the Reviewer Checklist, and their answers match what you see in the recording.
- No **critical checklist items** were missed
- Every review comment is tied to checklist items, and the reviewer notes are clear and helpful. Comment is 1-2 sentences.
- Mistakes in Metadata.rtf were corrected, and the AutoQC results were validated.
- The send-back rules were followed (see QC rules to remember).

If you want to give the reviewer feedback, leave it in the Internal Notes text box or DM them. If you see the same reviewer missing the same thing more than once, flag it to an EPM.

QC rules to remember

- The same send-back rules apply to QC as to reviewers:
    - Complexity send-backs are for Review 1 only. On a resubmission, do not send back for complexity. If the task is otherwise approvable, approve it and note your concern in Internal Notes.
    - If the Reviewer raised the complexity issue in R1 and the writer didn't fix it, then R2 can send back.
- **NEW - We have aligned the QC checklist to the reviewer checklist**
- If the recording differs from the Task Description or the app listed, and the task is otherwise approvable, note it in Internal Notes and approve.
- If the reviewer missed a mistake in Metadata.rtf, correct it and re-upload the file.
- **When you are unsure** (Narration, PII edge cases, passive AI features, SWE/ML exceptions), **escalate before you decide.** Post in the QC channel or check with an EPM.
- For the condition 'Narration says what, where and why for every action,' please align to the following condition:
    - **If the task contains ≥70% of 2 of the 3 of where, what, and why in its narration, IT IS APPROVABLE!!**

AutoQC checks

You are asked to verify various AQC flags on the task. For each flag, compare with the recording and make your assessment of what tolerance criteria it aligns with. If the writer disputed a flag, check their explanation against the recording and score what you see. Mention in your comment whether you agreed with the dispute.

Minor (advice) flags never block approval on their own. Score the checklist items as usal.

Possible AQC cards on the task:

Files and deliverables

- Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow): see checklist item 1.
    - Fails when Metadata.rtf is under 80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or Studio.

Recording

- No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s: see checklist item 2.
    - 6–30 s = edge case (3); over 30 s = fail (4).
- Mouse never idle >45 s (no checklist item; score it here on the same ranges):
    - 1: never idle over 45 s.
    - 3: idle 45–60 s, one to three times.
    - 4: idle over 60 s at least once, or 45–60 s more than three times.

- The closing epilogue is exempt.

Writer performance

- Narration says what, where, and why for every action: see checklist item 3.
  - Fails when under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws. An action is anything that changes the state of the document.
- Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task: see checklist item 5.

AutoQC checks of task elements (for reference purpose):

1. All four task files uploaded (MP4, deliverables.zip, Task Recorder zip, Metadata.rtf)
2. Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present
3. video.mp4 opens
4. Deliverables named correctly
5. Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, OTA, workflow)
6. Video length within 15 to 54:59 minutes
7. Dock stays visible (not covered) in the start and end of recording
8. No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s
   a. **Major flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for >30s
   b. **Minor flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for 6-30s
9. Mouse never idle >45 s
   a. **Major flag:** Mouse idle for >60s
   b. **Minor flag:** Mouse idle for ≥3 stretches within 45–60s
10. Narration says what, where and why for every action
11. Narration names what and where, no 'click here' / 'change this'
12. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task
13. Metadata.rtf apps listed match the apps listed in Studio
14. Dock is not positioned at the bottom of the screen
15. Accessibility Inspector icon is visible in the Dock with a dot underneath
16. Accessibility Inspector window is not visible during the recording (exception: first-time writers)
17. At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup
18. Typing is at most 20% of video length (coding and content & writing exception: up to ~30%)
19. The task contains zero use of restricted apps
20. Narration cadence and workflow interactions are followable at normal speed

QC Auditor Checklist

Below is the Project Odin QC Auditor checklist that will be used to verify the quality of tasks on Project Odin. When reviewing a task, you will be selecting which tolerance criteria have been met for each checklist item, which is on the following scale:

- 1 = Within client tolerance
- 2 = Within acceptable tolerance
- 3 = Within edge case tolerance
- 4 = Failing tolerance

Some checklist items have binary tolerance criteria - they either fulfilled it (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (4 = No). Other checklist items have a range which will be described within each checklist item.

Checklist item	**Criteria**			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
1. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow)	Yes	Metadata.rtf >80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal and to Studio	Metadata.rtf >70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal and to Studio	Metadata.rtf <70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or to Studio
2. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s	Yes	An unused window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for 6–30 s	N/A	An unused window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for >30 s with no clear effort to fix within time
3. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Narration says what, where and why for every	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws (an action is

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
action				anything that changes the state of the document)
4. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Eyes closed test: Viewer clearly understands what actions are being performed in the video with eyes closed (no 'click here', 'change this')	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws
5. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
6. [Manual] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
7. [Manual] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
8. [Manual] Keep the intro under 20 seconds: say the intro sentence, minimize the Goal document, start.	Yes	21-60 s	N/A	>60s
9. [Manual] Filling out Metadata.rtf is not shown in the recording.	Yes	No, filling out Metadata.rtf shown for 10 s or less		No, filling out Metadata.rtf shown for >10 s
10. [Manual] Typing takes up 20% of the video or less (up to about 30% for coding and content & writing tasks).	Yes	No, typing takes up <25% of the video (<30% for coding and content & writing)	N/A	No, typing takes up ≥25% of the video (≥30% for coding and content & writing)

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
11. [Manual] Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.	Yes	46–60 s	N/A	Over 60 s
12. [Manual] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)	Yes	No, background noise 30–40% of the narration	N/A	No, background noise over 40% of the narration
13. [Manual] The TaskRecorder window only appears when starting or stopping the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
14. [Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click (i.e. they don't click too fast)	Yes	No, missing in 1-6 segments	No, missing in 6-12 segments	No, the writer consistently clicks too fast
15. [Manual] The recording is free of AI use. (Allowed: AI features part of an app's normal tools)	Yes	No, Google AI Overview (no follow-ups), autocomplete, SWE/ML	N/A	No, AI interaction present
16. [Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
17. [Manual] The recording is free of paywalled or copyrighted content.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
18. [Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	No, minor profanity on screen, not typed by the writer	N/A	No, profanity said or typed by the writer, or more than minor on-screen

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
				profanity
19. [Manual] Task is recorded in English and all task materials are in English	Yes	N/A	N/A	No/Cannot verify
20. [Manual] Recording includes an epilogue narration (a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges, quality, and reflections) of 4 minutes or less, before stopping recording (only for ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT). Target 3-4 minutes with no 3-minute minimum. All duration bands over 4:00 exceed the maximum; they record severity, not an allowance for extra duration.	Yes	No, narration length is between 4:01-4:30 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	No, the narration lacked detail / length is between 4:31-5:00 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	N/A
21. [Manual] The task contains sufficient complexity / domain expertise (e.g., multi-step workflow, domain judgement, use of multiple tools, output that would be produced for real work)	Yes	A non-expert can do <10% of actions	N/A	No, a non-expert can do >10% of the actions

🏅 Bad Example 🏅

Use the Bad Example to study Project Odin quality guideline violations.

1. Data Science and Analytics

Task Description

As a data scientist who is compiling information to help guide decision making for the upcoming state election in Victoria, I have been tasked with presenting specific demographic data to decision makers. As part of this I need to prefer data for age demogramphics for a regional town area (Ararat, VIC) against overall state averages to be used in a future presentation.

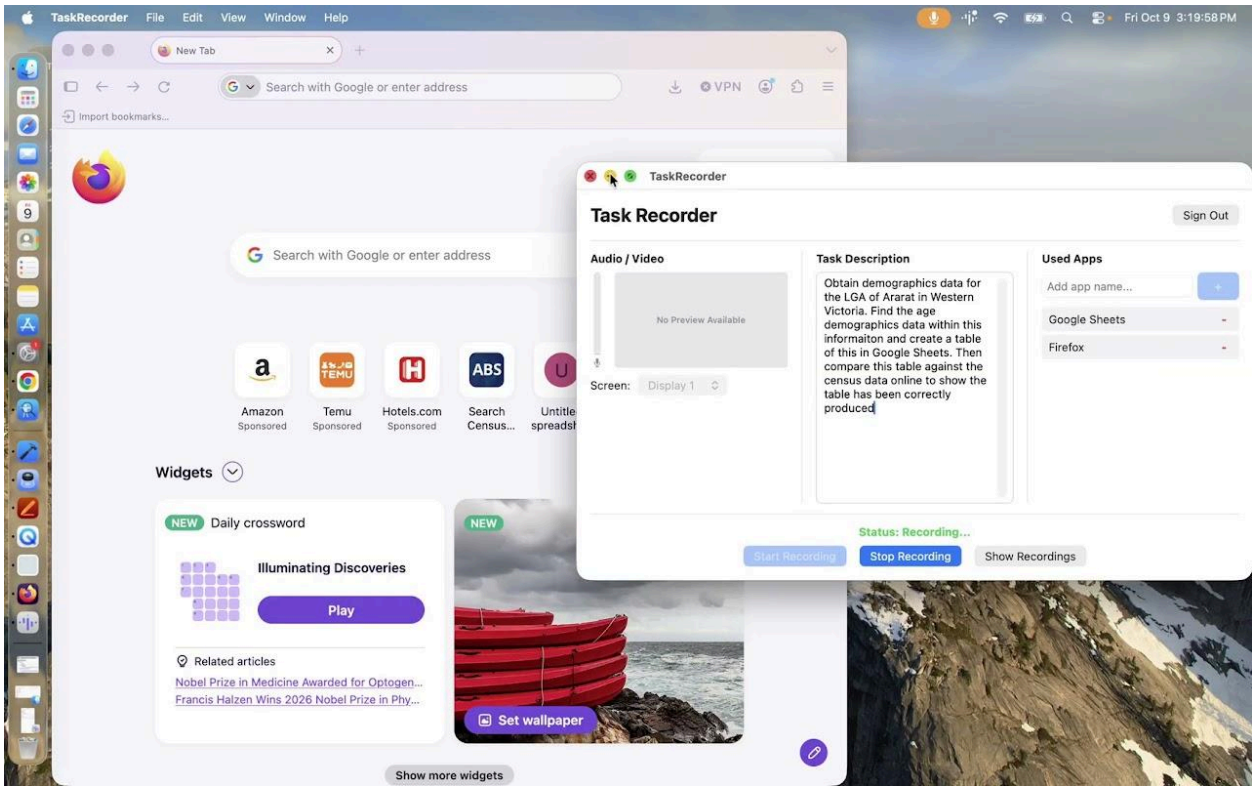
I will use Firefox to obtain the data for the publicly available census 2026 data that can be commercial planning, market research, and strategy and download as a CSV file. I will then load the data into Google Sheets to analyse the data and create a plot of the data in a comparison format between the community and state. I will then print the data to pdf to be used as required, and open it in preview to show that the print worked.

Apps Used

Firefox

Google Sheets

Video: Full task recording (16:41)



Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
[Manual] Metadata.rtf apps listed match the apps listed in Studio	Yes			
[Manual] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes			
[Manual] The Dock is visible at the start and end of the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The Dock is on the left or right side of the screen, not the bottom.	Yes			
[Manual] The Accessibility Inspector icon is in the Dock with a dot under it, which means the app is running.	Yes			
[Manual] The Accessibility Inspector window stays hidden during the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The TaskRecorder window only appears when starting or stopping the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The TaskRecorder window shows the correct task description and apps.	Yes			
[Manual] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.				No
[Manual] Filling out Metadata.rtf is absent in the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of AI use. (Allowed: AI features part of an app's normal tools)	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of Studio, Mercor, or project information.	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of paywalled or copyrighted content.	Yes			
[Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity and explicit content.	Yes			
[Manual] The narration and actions are easy to follow at normal (1x) speed.	Followable at normal speed			
[Manual] Each pause in narration lasts 45 seconds or less.	Yes			

[Manual] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)	0%			
[Manual] The task follows the current banned-app, limited-use and app-specific rules; unrestricted apps need no prior approval.				No
[Manual] Typing takes up 20% of the video or less (up to about 30% for coding tasks).	Yes, ≤20% of task			
[Manual] The video shows professional-level skill in the domain, meaning it isn't something anyone could do.	Yes			
[Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click.				No, missing in 11+ segments
[Manual] Task checklist and PII confirmation were truthfully completed by the writer				No
[Manual] At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup	Yes			
[Manual] Task is recorded in English	Yes			

What makes a good vs. a bad task

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
Has a complex goal, every app's use, professionally usable deliverables and steps to verify their outcome that shows the writer's professional domain expertise.	Has repetitive steps or a workflow that could be completed by a friend/junior stall personnel in the same domain.
Has no set-up issues (menubar is visible with the seconds, accessibility inspector has a dot underneath it and TaskRecorder is prefilled with the goal and the task apps)	Set-up is incomplete/absent
Task length is within the 15 minute and 54:59 minute threshold	Task length is either lower than the 15 minute threshold or over the 54:59 minute threshold
Does not contain any PII	Contains details like personal emails, contact information, name or addresses.
Does not use any restricted apps.	Uses restricted apps.
No AI accessed during the task	The writer uses AI during their recording/ interacts with AI prompts such as 'Ask me anything'.
Has all the 4 files including the Metadata.rtf file, video.mp4 file, recording_TIMESTAMP.zip and the deliverables.zip	Is missing one or all the files required to review the task.
The deliverables.zip contains all the files including the input file, artifacts and final outputs.	The deliverables.zip contains is missing the final output
Dock is positioned to the left or right of the screen	Dock is positioned at the bottom of the screen.
Has at least one UI element changed apart from the position of the dock, such as the wallpaper, resolution, the mode or the colour of the icons.	No UI change apart from the position of the dock.
No applications and windows covered by another window (excluding pop-ups within the same app) by more than approximately 25% for more than 6s.	Applications and windows covered/stacked by another window (excluding pop-ups within the same app) by more than approximately 25% for more

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
	than 6s.
Mouse inactivity is less than 45s outside the closing epilogue; the mouse may remain still during the epilogue.	Mouse inactivity is more than 45 s
Typing is <20% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and less than <30% for a coding or Content & Writing task	Typing is >20% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and >30% for a coding or Content & Writing task
Narration covers the 2 of the 3Ws for at least 70% of the total task length and is precise.	Narration covers the 2 of the 3Ws for at least <70% of the total task length, and is vague with the writer using words like ‘this’ and ‘here’.
Metadata.rtf file is hidden throughout the task and does not appear in the recording.	Metadata.rtf file is not hidden throughout the task and appears in the recording.
No project related apps or references appear on screen, i.e., Insightful window is not visible, project related tabs are closed.	Project related apps or references appear on screen when recording.

🏅 Golden Examples 🏅

Use the Golden Examples to study task complexity, professional workflow, and narration standards.

---

1. Finance
2. Design
3. Audio & Music
4. Animation & VFX
5. Software & AI/ML Engineering

---

1. Finance

Task Description

I am an Account Receivable personnel at a company in the UK and have been tasked with adding a new vendor to our ERP system and creating a Purchase Order (PO) tracking workflow for our Accounting team to manage POs better. I will begin by adding missing information onto a sample PO on the Pages app, then transfer the vendor details, and PO line items onto our ERP system on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central, and finally create a PO tracking workflow on Monday.com. I will verify the flow is complete by running the same at the end of its creation and check if the status updates as per the trigger, and deliver the final PO raised on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central and the PO workflow from Monday.com to my team.

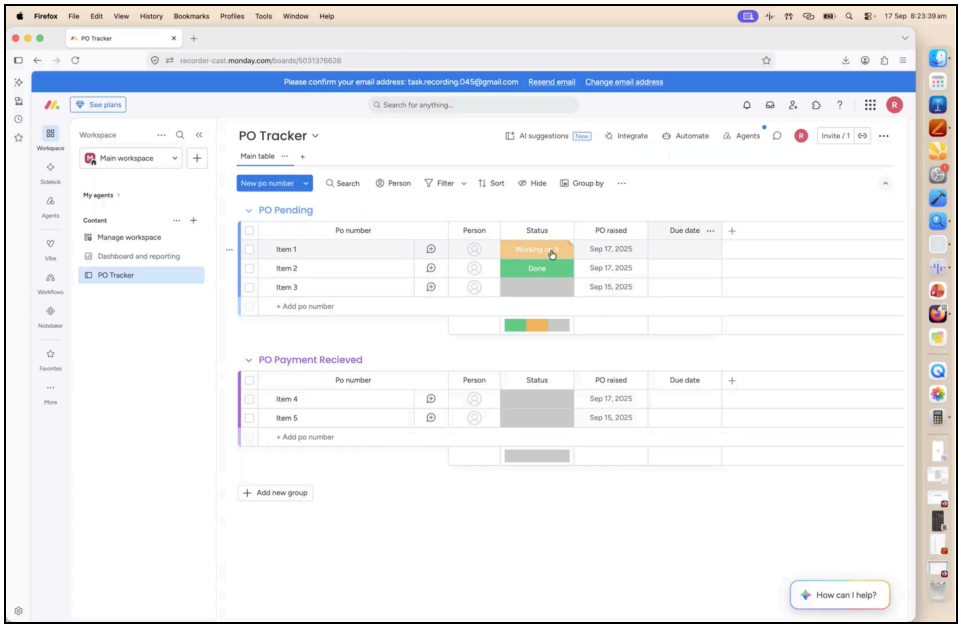
Apps Used

Monday.com

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central

Pages

Video: Full task recording (44:19)


PO Tracker
Please confirm your email address: task.recording.045@gmail.com Resend email Change email address
See plans
Search for anything...
Workspace
Main workspace
My agents
Content
Manage workspace
Dashboard and reporting
PO Tracker
PO Tracker
AI suggestions
Integrate
Automate
Agents
Invite / 1
Main table
New po number
Search
Person
Filter
Sort
Hide
Group by
PO Pending
Po number
Person
Status
PO raised
Due date
Item 1
Working on it
Sep 17, 2025
Item 2
Done
Sep 17, 2025
Item 3
Sep 15, 2025
+ Add po number
PO Payment Recieved
Po number
Person
Status
PO raised
Due date
Item 4
Sep 17, 2025
Item 5
Sep 15, 2025
+ Add po number
Add new group
How can I help?

2. Design

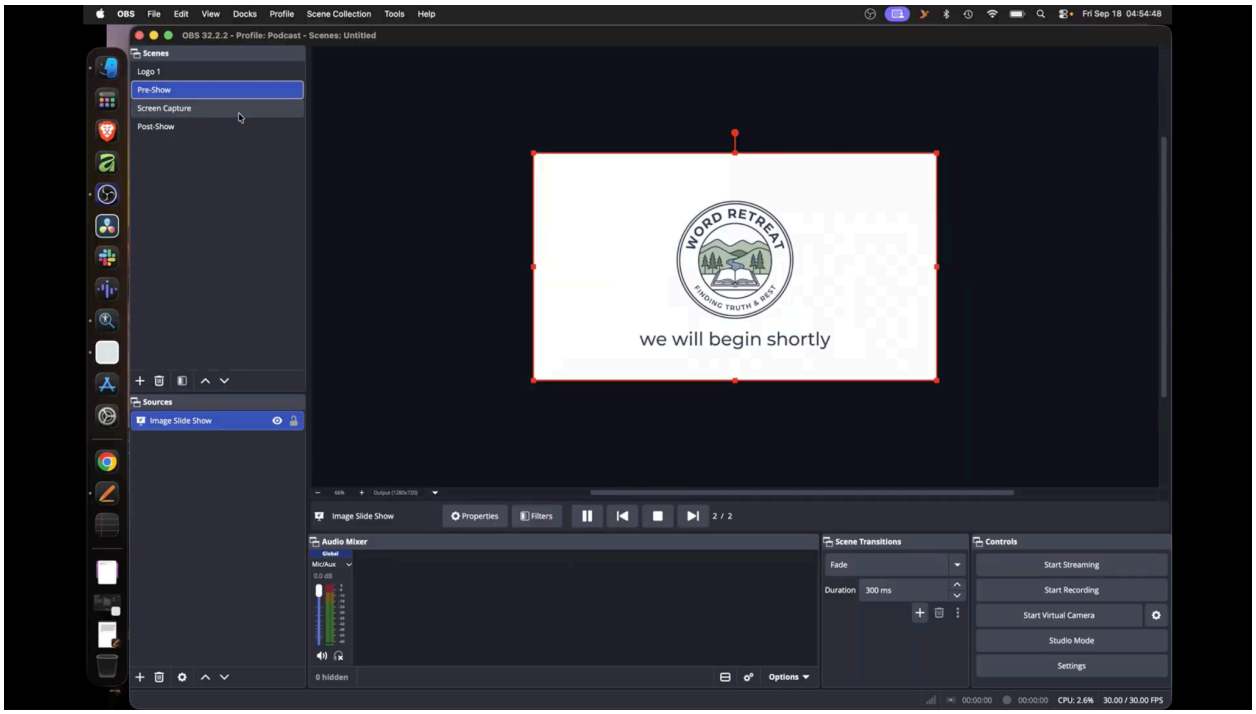
Task Description

I am a Content Creator preparing aspects of a new podcast. Using OBS Studio, I will setup different scenes for different aspects of the podcast such as pre-show and screen-share, which will involve the import of some images. The final deliverables will be the export of the scenes created in OBS.

Apps Used

OBS Studio

Video: Full task recording (24:44)



3. Audio & Music

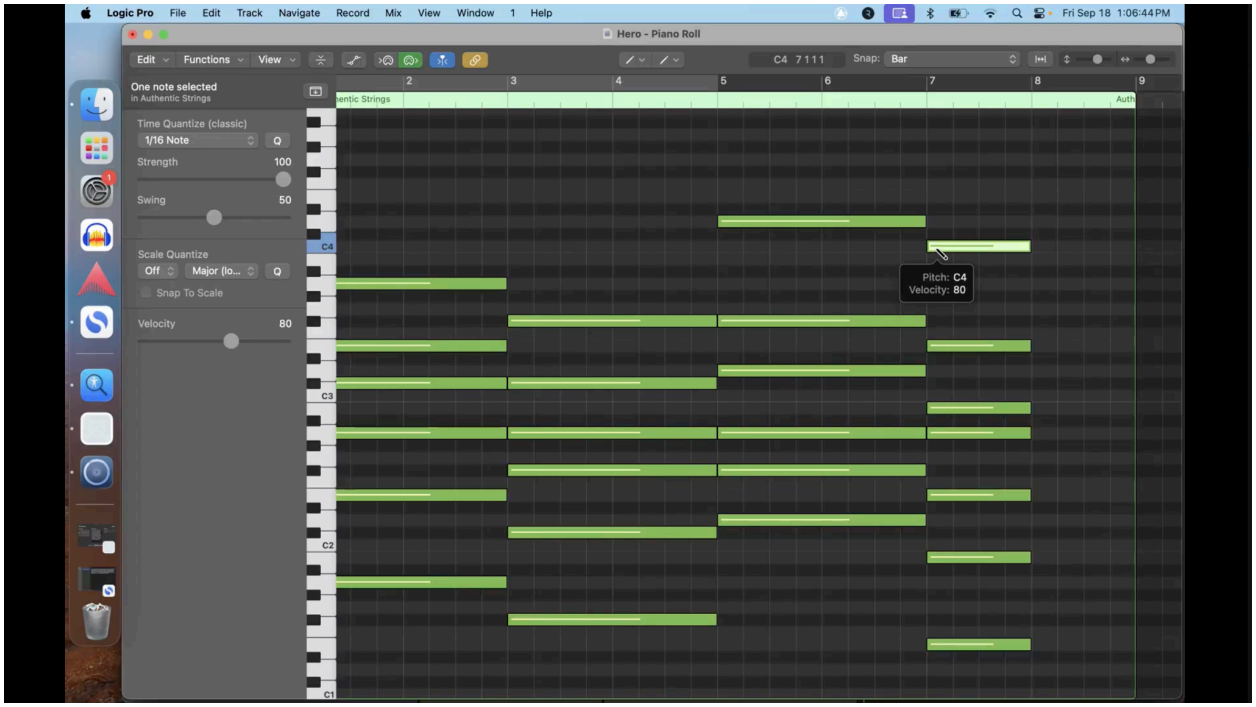
Task Description

I am a film score composer and I'm working on the underlying theme for a heroic end credit sequence. I will use Logic Pro in the second phase (P2) of the execution to compose a string accompaniment for the piano top melody created in phase one (PI). I will also establish a chordal sequence (I - vi - IV - V) to define the passage. The final deliverable will be a stereo export of the complete Logic Pro session.

Apps Used

Logic Pro

Video: Full task recording (22:58)



4. Animation & VFX

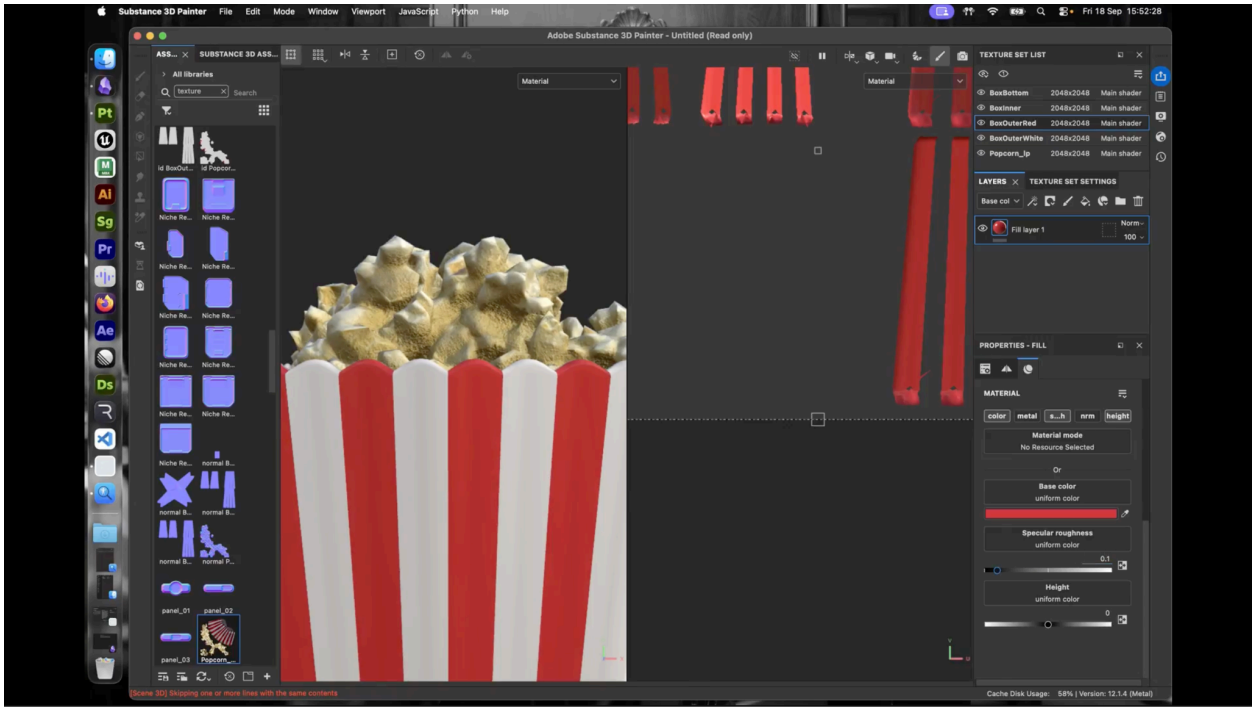
Task Description

You are a 3D Modeler tasked with cleaning up the textures of a photogrammetry model for use in Unreal Engine. Use Adobe Substance 3D Painter to bake the provided high poly model onto the provided low poly model, apply the provided photogrammetry diffuse texture, clean up artifacts on the texture, add a powdery finish to the popcorn and add red and white striped packaging textures to the popcorn box. Export the texture maps appropriate for use in Unreal Engine.

Apps Used

Substance 3D Painter

Video: Full task recording (40:59)



5. Software & AI/ML Engineering

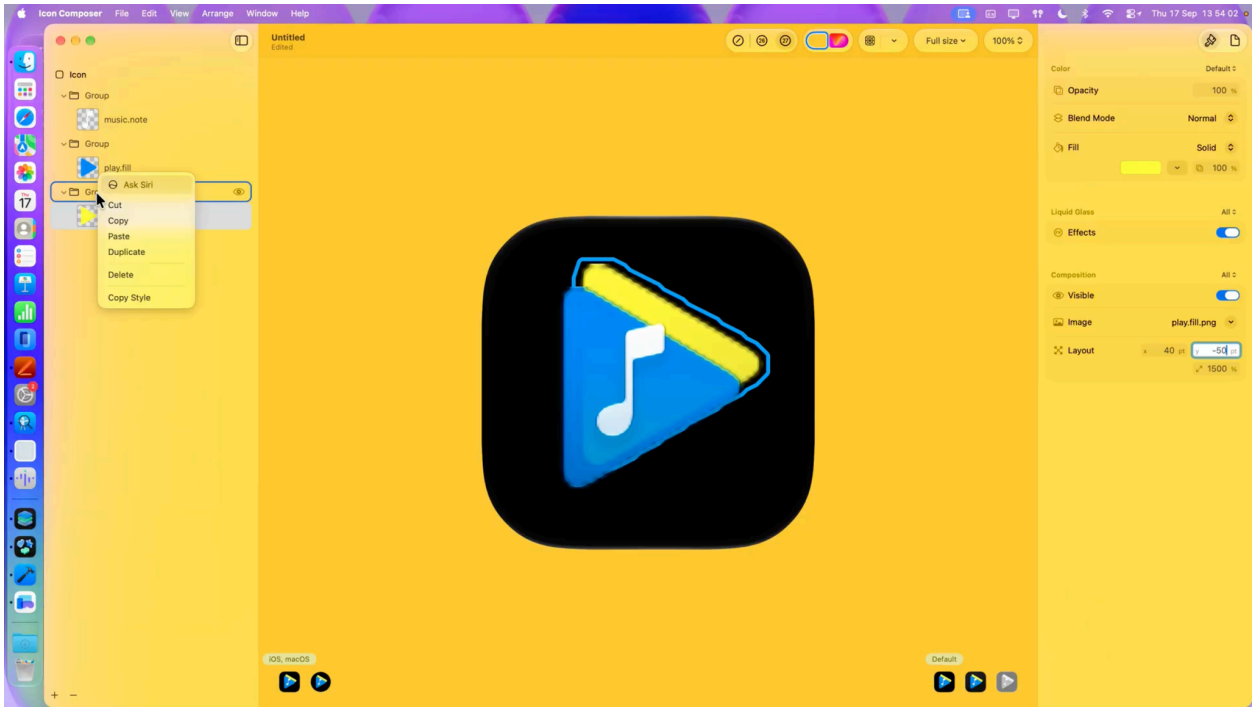
Task Description

As an iOS app developer I want to create a distinctive visual identity for a simple Music Player app. Use SF Symbols as independent visual components, and compose them as separate layers in Icon Composer. Build & refine the multi-layered icon in Icon Composer and integrate the resulting icon into a SwiftUI Music Player app in Xcode. Deliver the layered icon and Xcode project; verify that the app builds successfully and the icon is correctly integrated.

Apps Used

Device Hub
Xcode
SF Symbols
Icon Composer

Video: Full task recording (28:37)



Odin Reviewer Playbook: Faster Reviews

Target: average review time under 45 minutes per task, with the same quality bar. AHT is looked at together with your QC pass rate, so speed only counts if your approvals hold up.

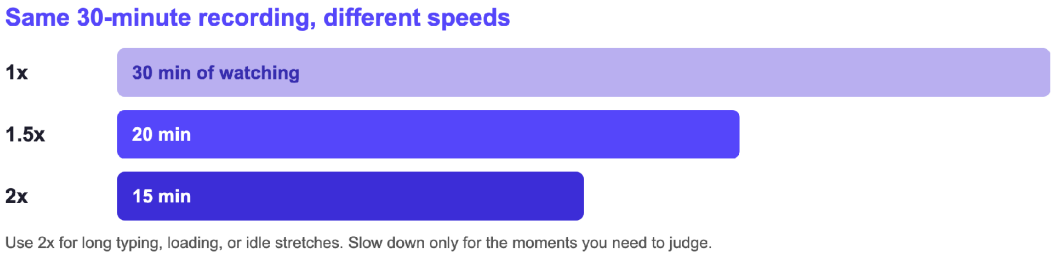
The 30-second version

1. Watch at **1.5x or faster** with live captions on.
2. Check **every AutoQC flag**: confirm the real ones, dismiss the false ones.
3. Spend your watch time on what AutoQC misses, **narration first**.
4. Found a critical issue? Take **~10 more minutes** to catch other critical issues, then send back with the template.
5. Minor issue you can fix yourself? **Fix it and approve.**

What's in this guide

- 1) Quick Wins
- 2) The Efficient Review Flow
- 3) What AutoQC Misses
- 4) Quick Send-Backs
- 5) Fix and Approve vs Send Back
- 6) Re-reviews
- 7) Habits That Slow You Down

1) Quick Wins



- **Watch at 1.5x or faster.** Go to 2x through long typing, loading, or idle stretches, and skip ahead when nothing new is happening on screen.
- **Turn on live captions** (Chrome Live Caption or macOS Live Captions). Reading the narration while you watch makes the narration check much faster.
- **Start loading the video as soon as you claim the task.** Do the Goal and metadata check while it buffers.

- **Clear "My re-reviews" first**, then work the Prioritized Review Queue from the top. See the Re-reviews section for more details.
- **Jump to timestamps, don't rewatch.** Use AutoQC flag timestamps to go straight to the moment in question.
- **Keep feedback short.** One line per issue with a timestamp and the fix. Use the send-back template in Section 4.

2) The Efficient Review Flow



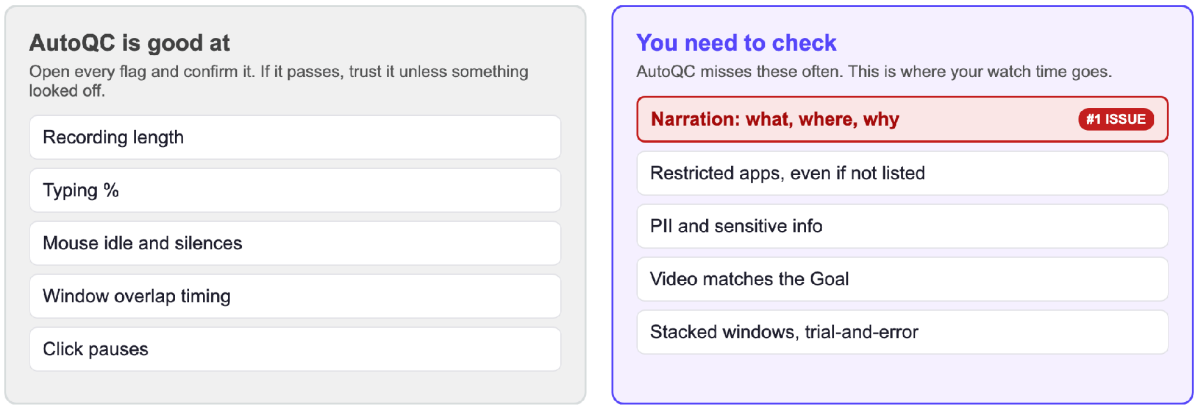
In step 3, focus on the checks in Section 3: What AutoQC Misses.

Step 2 in detail: checking AutoQC flags

- Open **every** flag, major and minor, jump to its timestamp, and decide if it is real.
- **Real flag:** treat it like any issue you found yourself (Sections 4 and 5).
- **False flag:** dismiss it and move on. Common false flags: mouse idle while the writer is typing, "no narration found" on videos with audible narration, and the TaskRecorder window flagged for a split second.
- If AutoQC passes something, you don't need to recheck it unless something on screen looked off.

3) What AutoQC Misses

Who checks what

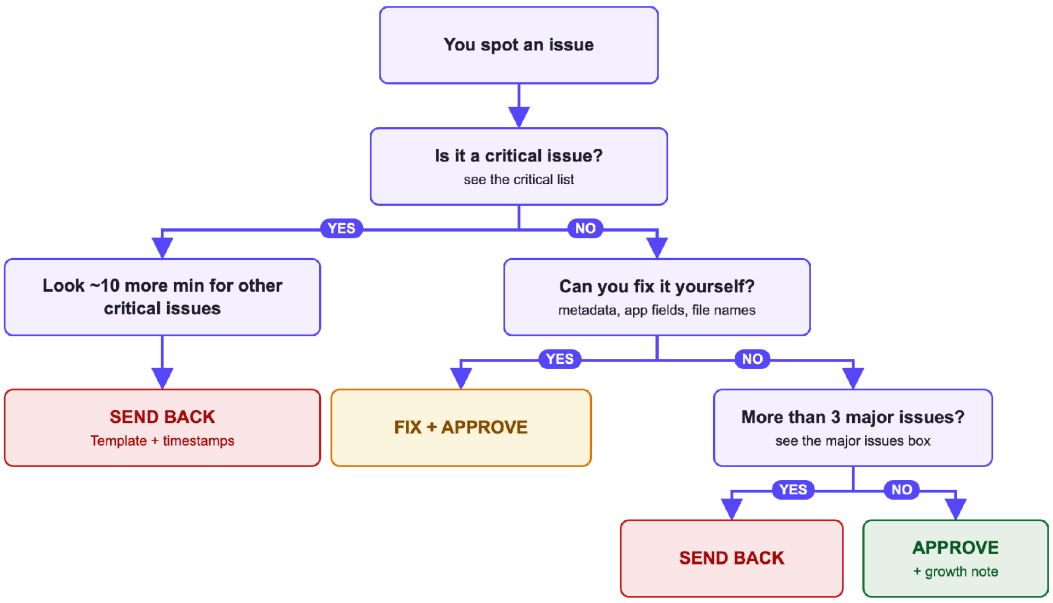


Narration is by far the most common quality issue. It is the top reason writers get sent back, and the top issue QC finds in tasks reviewers approved. Give it most of your attention.

- **Narration:** does it explain what is happening, where on screen, and why? Would it pass the eyes-closed test (could you follow along without seeing the screen)? Watch for vague words like "this", "that", "here".
- **Restricted apps:** check every app that appears on screen against the Restricted Apps list, even ones opened for a few seconds. A frequent miss: the writer uses a restricted app but doesn't list it in Studio, or even in TaskRecorder, so it only shows up in the video.
- **PII and sensitive info:** personal email addresses, account details, addresses, financial or private data on screen.
- **Video matches the Goal:** the writer actually completes the task described.
- **Stacked windows and trial-and-error:** windows fully covered by another window, or fumbling that makes the workflow hard to follow.

4) Quick Send-Backs

Found an issue? What to do



If you confirm one of the critical issues below, **you don't need to finish the full review.** Spend **about 10 more minutes** scanning for other critical issues (especially the common ones in Section 3), so the writer can fix everything in one re-record. Then send back using the template.

Critical issue	What it looks like
Narration fails	Missing narration, or narration that fails the eyes-closed test across much of the video. One weak sentence is not a fail.
Restricted app used	Any restricted app on screen, whether or not it is listed in Studio or TaskRecorder. No leeway. If it is the only issue, follow the hold-and-escalate process in the reviewer guide.
PII or sensitive info	Personal email address, account details, addresses, or financial info visible for more than a passing moment. Using a personal account is fine as long as none of this is shown.
Video doesn't match the Goal	The task isn't completed, or the writer does a different task than described.
Desktop setup missed	Any of: clock without seconds, Dock at the bottom or hidden, Accessibility Inspector not running, nothing changed from a standard Mac desktop (wallpaper, dark mode, icon size, etc.), or TaskRecorder fields not filled in before recording.

Critical issue	What it looks like
Task too simple (first review only)	Not a multi-step expert workflow. Someone with no domain knowledge could do it.

Rule of thumb: send back if any critical item fails, or if more than 3 major items fail. Everything else is approvable.

Major issues (count only clear fails): metadata.rtf or TaskRecorder shown mid-recording briefly but corrected, non-obvious project info on screen, a single silence over 80 seconds, minor background noise throughout, rushed narration that is still understandable, missing click pauses, non-obvious copyrighted content, etc.

Send-back template (paste into Reviewer Comments for quick reviews)

Hi! Sending this back so you can fix the following:

• **[Issue]** at **[timestamp]**: [what to change]

• **[Issue]** at **[timestamp]**: [what to change]

Before you re-record, a quick check on the most common issues:

• **Narration:** say what you're doing, where on screen, and why. Someone with their eyes closed should be able to follow. Avoid "this", "that", "here".

• **Restricted apps:** check every app you open, even briefly, against the Restricted Apps list. List every app you use in Studio and TaskRecorder.

• **PII:** close personal email, accounts, and notifications before recording.

• **Setup:** clock with seconds, Dock on the left or right, Accessibility Inspector running, and at least one change from the standard Mac desktop.

• **Goal:** make sure the recording completes the exact task in your Goal.

Thank you for your hard work!

5) Fix and Approve vs Send Back

A send-back costs the writer a re-record and costs you a second review. If you can fix it yourself, or it is minor, **fix it, leave a growth note, and approve.**

Issue	Action	How
metadata.rtf errors (Request wording, topology, small mismatches with the Goal)	**FIX + APPROVE**	Fix it yourself. Never send back for metadata alone.
Goal and TaskRecorder text describe the same task but aren't word-for-word identical	**FIX + APPROVE**	Fix metadata if needed.
A non-restricted app was used but not listed, or a listed app wasn't used	**FIX + APPROVE**	Update the app fields and files so they match the video.
Deliverable file name is slightly off	**FIX + APPROVE**	Rename the file yourself.
A restricted app appears in the video, listed or not	**SEND BACK**	See Section 4.
Desktop setup missed (clock, Dock, Accessibility Inspector, no change from a standard Mac)	**SEND BACK**	See Section 4.
Brief glimpse of "Mercor", "Odin", a project folder, or a non-sensitive item	**APPROVE**	No note needed.
Intro a few seconds over	**APPROVE**	Growth note.
Window overlap between 6 and 30 seconds as the only issue	**APPROVE**	Growth note.
Typing a little over the limit, short idle or silent stretches, pauses after clicks under 1 second	**APPROVE**	Growth note.
More than 3 major issues together (see Section 4)	**SEND BACK**	Use the template.

6) Re-reviews

Re-reviews should be much faster. You already know the task, and the writer has fixed your notes, so there is usually less to flag and less to write.

- **Only files changed?** Check the items from the last send-back and the new AutoQC result. No need to rewatch the whole video.

- **Re-recorded?** Watch it, but focus on the issues you flagged last time and the Section 3 checks.
- **Resubmitted with no changes?** Send back quickly, pointing to the original note.

7) Habits That Slow You Down

- Watching at 1x from start to finish.
- Watching to the end after you've already confirmed a critical issue.
- Sending back for a minor issue you could fix yourself.
- Writing long feedback instead of more pointed bullets that are easier for the writer understand.

Questions or edge cases: post in the #odin-reviewers-hub channel with the task link.

Odin Reviewer DM Templates

How to use

Every DM is built from three parts:

- Header
- Opener (sections 2–5)
- One snippet per item that did not score 1 (sections 6–7).
    - The lowest score on the checklist decides which opener you use.

Header line for every DM:

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
```

Writing rules for every snippet:

- Give a timestamp (MM:SS) for anything seen in the video.
- Say what was wrong, why the client needs it, and what to do next time.
- Use the current status names: Needs Edits and Rejected (not "Needs Revision").
- Point to the Writer Guidelines section by name when it helps.

Approved (all items at 1)

Use when every manual item and every AutoQC card passes. Delete any line that does not apply to this task.

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Comments: Task approved. Clear, well-paced recording narrated with
What, Where and Why. Setup verified: menu bar clock shows seconds,
Dock visible on the left/right at start and end, Accessibility
Inspector running with its window hidden, at least one UI element
changed. TaskRecorder shown only at start and stop, with the
```

```
correct Goal and apps. Goal document shown and intro kept under 20
seconds. Metadata.rtf matches Studio (apps, workflow) and was not
shown in the recording. Current banned-app, limited-use and
app-specific rules followed; unrestricted apps need no prior
approval; no AI use, PII, project information,
copyrighted/paywalled content or profanity. Good window management,
deliberate clicks, and typing within limits. Video length,
screenshot count, recording ZIP, video.mp4 and deliverables.zip
verified. Professional-level work with a complete final
deliverable.
```

Approved with growth notes (worst item at 2 or 3)

Use when the task passes, but one or more items scored 2 or 3. Paste the matching snippets from section 6 under "Areas to grow".

None

```
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Hi ___,

I've approved task ___. You did a strong job on ___.

Areas to grow for your next tasks:
- [paste snippet]
- [paste snippet]

None of these blocked approval this time, but items at the edge of
tolerance can fail on a future task. The Workflow Checklist in the
Writer Guidelines covers each one. Keep up the great work!
```

Needs Edits (any item at 4)

Use when at least one item fails, but the task can still be fixed within its approved idea. Split fixes into what needs a re-record and what only needs files or metadata corrected, so the writer knows the size of the job.

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Hi ___,

I've completed my review of task ___. You did a good job on ___,
but the items below need to be fixed before I can approve it.

Requires a re-record:
- [paste snippet]

Requires a file or metadata fix only:
- [paste snippet]

Growth notes (did not block approval):
- [paste snippet]

Please run both AutoQC checks again before resubmitting, and use
the Workflow Checklist in the Writer Guidelines. Once these are
addressed, the next version should be ready to approve. I look
forward to seeing it!
```

Rejected (Invalid Task Idea)

Rejected status is for tasks that cannot be fixed through edits, such as an invalid task concept. Many fails in one task is a Needs Edits, not a Rejected. If you are unsure if the task description is valid, DM the writer and Send for Edits instead. Pick the reason that applies and delete the others.

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Hi ___,

I've completed my review of task ___. Unfortunately, this task
can't be approved or fixed through edits, for the reason below.
Please don't resubmit this task.
```

- Task concept: The approved workflow doesn't seem like it can be completed without [excessive typing /exceeding the allotted timeframe], so no re-record of this idea would meet the requirements.
- Does not match approval: The recording performs a different task from the approved idea. Material changes need a change request approved before recording.

For your next task, please propose a new idea in Studio and review the Professional Expertise and Task Variety section of the Writer Guidelines. I look forward to your next submission.

Item-by-item snippets

Setup and TaskRecorder

Metadata.rtf apps match Studio — 4, file fix

Menu bar clock shows seconds — 4

Dock visible at start and end — 4

Dock on left or right — 4

Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon) — 4

Accessibility Inspector window hidden — 4

TaskRecorder window only at start and stop — 4

TaskRecorder shows the correct task description and apps — 4

Task description document shown at start — 4

Intro in 20 seconds or less

Filling out Metadata.rtf absent from recording — 4

At least 1 UI element changed — 4

Recorded in English, all materials in English — 4

Content and compliance

Free of AI use (AI features part of an app's normal tools allowed) — 4

Free of PII (screen and audio) — 4

Free of Studio, or project information — 4

Free of paywalled or copyrighted content — 4

Free of profanity and explicit content — 4

Follows restricted-app and limited-use rules; no approval needed for unrestricted apps: 4

Shows professional-level skill — 4

Task checklist and PII confirmation completed truthfully — 4

Performance

Easy to follow at 1x speed

Each narration pause 45 seconds or less

Narration audio clear (loud typing OK if narration stays clear)

Typing 20% or less (about 30% for Coding / Content & Writing)

Pauses at least 1 second after each mouse click

Setup and TaskRecorder

Metadata.rtf apps match Studio — 4, file fix

None

```
Metadata.rtf - The apps and request(goal) listed in Metadata.rtf
don't match Studio. Please update Metadata.rtf so the apps and
workflow match Studio and the recording, then re-upload it in its
own Studio field.
```

Menu bar clock shows seconds — 4

None

```
Clock seconds - The menu bar clock doesn't show seconds [or:
couldn't be verified at MM:SS]. Go to System Settings > Menu Bar >
Clock Options and turn on "Display the time with seconds," then
re-record.
```

Dock visible at start and end — 4

None

```
Dock visibility - The Dock was hidden at the during the recording.
Please keep the Dock visible for the whole recording, especially at
the start and end, and use ordinary Fill instead of Full Screen so
it stays on screen.
```

Dock on left or right — 4

None

```
Dock position - The Dock is at the bottom of the screen. Please
move it to the left or right in System Settings > Desktop & Dock
before re-recording.
```

Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon) — 4

None

```
Accessibility Inspector - Accessibility Inspector wasn't running during the recording (no dot under its Dock icon). TaskRecorder needs it running for the whole recording to capture the required data. Open it from Xcode > Open Developer Tool, close only its window with the red button, and confirm the dot stays under its icon.
```

Accessibility Inspector window hidden — 4

None

```
Accessibility Inspector window - The Accessibility Inspector window was visible at MM:SS. Close its window with the red button before recording (don't minimize or quit the app) so it keeps running in the background.
```

TaskRecorder window only at start and stop — 4

None

```
TaskRecorder window - The TaskRecorder window was open at MM:SS. Please minimize it right after clicking Start Recording and only bring it back when you're ready to click Stop Recording.
```

TaskRecorder shows the correct task description and apps — 4

None

```
TaskRecorder fields - The TaskRecorder Task Description/Used Apps didn't match the approved task description. Before clicking Start Recording, paste only the approved Goal, exactly as written, and list every app used. Check for leftover details from your previous task.
```

Task description document shown at start — 4

None

```
Opening Task Description Document - The Goal document wasn't shown at the start of the recording. After starting, minimize TaskRecorder so the Goal document is visible, say the intro sentence, then minimize the document. Use Word, Google Docs or another allowed app (not Notes or TextEdit), and show only the Goal, not the Approval ID.
```

Intro in 20 seconds or less

None

```
Intro length - Your intro ran about __ seconds. For future tasks, say only "I will be beginning my task soon. Here is the workflow I have in mind," minimize the Goal document, and begin. The guidelines ask for under 20 seconds.
```

Filling out Metadata.rtf absent from recording — 4

None

```
Metadata.rtf visible - Metadata.rtf was [open/being filled out] at MM:SS. Please complete Metadata.rtf before recording and keep it closed during the recording.
```

At least 1 UI element changed — 4

None

```
UI diversity - The desktop uses the default Mac setup. Please change at least one UI element before recording, such as the wallpaper, light/dark mode, Dock size or resolution.
```

Recorded in English, all materials in English — 4

None

Language - [The narration / the file ___ / the app interface] was not in English at MM:SS. All narration and task materials must be in English, and the system language must stay set to English.

Content and compliance

Free of AI use (AI features part of an app's normal tools allowed) — 4

None

```
AI use - [Tool/feature] was used to [prompt / generate / summarize] at MM:SS. No AI interaction is allowed during recording, including Google AI Overview's "Ask anything" and AI Mode. Inputs may be prepared with Gemini before recording, with "AI-generated before recording" selected in Studio.
```

Free of PII (screen and audio) — 4

None

```
PII - ___ was [shown on screen / said aloud] at MM:SS. Please re-record without any private personal identifiable information, including names, emails, phone numbers, addresses, account details, biometrics, and Mac Addresses. TaskRecorder 2.4.4 requires no sign-in. Use your assigned mercor.expert email for app logins when required.
```

Free of Studio, Mercor or project information — 4

None

```
Project information - [Studio / Slack / the Writer Guidelines / a Mercor reference] was visible at MM:SS. Please [close / delete] all project materials before recording.
```

Free of paywalled or copyrighted content — 4

None

```
Copyright - ___ at MM:SS is [paywalled / watermarked / copyrighted / from an unclear-rights source]. Use only CC0 or public domain content and confirm the source terms allow commercial use and is
```

```
Free to use for AI/ML training; a search filter alone isn't enough.
Gemini-generated inputs prepared before recording are allowed.
```

Free of profanity and explicit content — 4

None

```
Profanity / explicit content - [Profanity was said / explicit
content was shown] at MM:SS. The narration and everything on screen
must be free of profanity and explicit content, so this needs to be
re-recorded.
```

Follows restricted-app and limited-use rules; no approval needed for unrestricted apps: 4

None

```
App-policy issue: ___ was [opened / shown / used] at MM:SS and
conflicts with this current banned-app or limited-use condition:
___. Check https://odin-mercor1.vercel.app/validated-apps and the
in-flight protections before requesting changes. An unlisted app or
missing prior app approval is not a failure by itself.
```

Shows professional-level skill — 4

None

```
Professional expertise - The work in this task could be completed
by someone without domain expertise. For example, ___ at MM:SS is a
basic action repeated without professional reasoning. Please show
the methods, standards, decisions and checks you'd use as a
professional, and explain why you make each choice.
```

Task checklist and PII confirmation completed truthfully — 4

None

```
Submission checklist - The checklist/PII confirmation was marked
complete, but ___ (MM:SS) does not meet that item. Please open the
```

```
checklist and PII guidelines and verify each item against your
recording before checking the box.
```

Performance

Easy to follow at 1x speed

Score 2 (a few areas rushed):

```
None
Pacing - A few spots felt rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS). For future tasks,
slow down at those moments: move, pause, point, then act, so
viewers can follow at normal speed.
```

Score 3 (some parts rushed):

```
None
Pacing - Several parts felt rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS, MM:SS), which is
at the edge of what we can accept. Please work at a natural pace,
let each action finish before the next one, and keep the cursor on
what you're describing.
```

Score 4 (most or all rushed):

```
None
Pacing - Most of the recording moved too fast to follow at normal
speed (for example MM:SS and MM:SS). Please re-record at a
deliberate pace: move, pause, point, then act, and let each result
appear before continuing.
```

Each narration pause 45 seconds or less

Score 2 (46–60s):

```
None
Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS. For
future tasks, keep narrating while you work, even during typing or
repeated steps, so no gap goes over 45 seconds.
```

Score 3 (61–80s):

```
None
Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS, well
over the 45-second limit and at the edge of what we can accept.
Please narrate what you're doing and why throughout, especially
during typing and waiting.
```

Score 4 (81s+):

```
None
Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS. No
silent gap may exceed 45 seconds, so this needs to be re-recorded
with continuous narration.
```

Narration audio clear (loud typing OK if narration stays clear)

Score 2 (about 30% of the video):

```
None
Audio quality - Background noise affected about 30% of the
recording (e.g., MM:SS). For future tasks, record in a quieter
space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone.
```

Score 3 (about 40% of the video):

```
None
Audio quality - Background noise affected about 40% of the
recording (e.g., MM:SS), which is at the edge of what we can
accept. Please do a short test recording before your next task and
use a quieter space or a dedicated microphone.
```

Score 4 (whole video):

```
None
Audio quality - Background noise made the narration hard to hear
throughout the recording. For future tasks, record in a quieter
space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone. Check the
```

```
microphone level in TaskRecorder first, and don't switch audio
devices during recording.
```

Typing 20% or less (about 30% for Coding / Content & Writing)

```
None
Typing - Typing took up about __% of your __-minute recording, over
the limit of 20% (30% for Coding and Content & Writing). Please
re-record with a mouse-driven workflow, and keep every typing
segment under 45 seconds. If the idea can't be done without heavy
typing, this may need a new task idea instead.
```

Pauses at least 1 second after each mouse click

Score 2 (missing in 1–3 segments):

```
None
Click pacing - A few clicks were rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS). For future
tasks, pause about one second after each click so the result is
captured.
```

Score 3 (missing in 4–10 segments):

```
None
Click pacing - Clicks were rushed in several places (MM:SS, MM:SS,
MM:SS), which is at the edge of what we can accept. Please click,
wait a second, then continue.
```

Score 4 (missing in 11+ segments):

```
None
Click pacing - Clicks were rushed throughout the recording (for
example MM:SS and MM:SS). The client needs about a one-second pause
after every click, so please click, wait a second, then continue.
```

AutoQC snippets

Ratings 1 and 2 need no snippet, though a short line for 2 shows the writer their dispute was read. Ratings 3 (disputed, I disagree) and 4 (failed / not run) use the fail snippet; for a 3, start with the dispute line.

Dispute lines:

```
None
AutoQC dispute (agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check and agree with you; it did not count against this task.
```

```
None
AutoQC dispute (not agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check but confirmed the issue at MM:SS, so it still needs to be fixed:
```

Not run:

```
None
AutoQC not run - The ___ AutoQC wasn't run before submission. Please run both AutoQCs (Files & Recording and Narration) and resolve any blocking findings before resubmitting.
```

[Files and deliverables (file fixes unless the recording itself is bad)]

All four task files uploaded

Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present

video.mp4 opens

Deliverables named correctly

Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, request, workflow)

Recording

Video length within 15:00 to 54:59

Dock visible at start and end — 4

No app window covers more than 25% of another for over 6s (allowed up to 30s)

Mouse never idle over 45s outside the closing epilogue; the mouse may remain still during the epilogue.

- Major flag (blocks submission): mouse idle for more than 60s at least once, or mouse idle for >45s more than four times. The closing epilogue is exempt from this mouse-idle rule.
- Minor flag, but permissable: mouse idle for 45-60s, one to three times

Writer performance

Narration says What, Where and Why (≥70% on 2 of the 3)

Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task

Files and deliverables

(file fixes unless the recording itself is bad)

All four task files uploaded

None

```
Missing files - ___ is missing from Studio. Each task needs four uploads: video.mp4, deliverables.zip, the TaskRecorder recording_TIMESTAMP.zip, and Metadata.rtf in its own field (not inside deliverables.zip).
```

Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present

None

```
Recording archive - The TaskRecorder zip is [missing files / has only __ screenshots for a __-second video, below 0.5 per second]. This data is required by the client, so the task needs to be re-recorded. Before your next recording, quit unused apps and large browser tabs, keep enough free storage, and run a short test. Don't rename, unzip or edit the original archive.
```

video.mp4 opens

None

```
Video file - video.mp4 [won't open / ends early at MM:SS / is corrupted]. Please check the beginning, middle and end in QuickTime before uploading. If the file is corrupted, the task needs to be re-recorded.
```

Deliverables named correctly

None

```
Deliverable naming - Please name the zip "deliverables.zip" and label files inside it as input 1, artifact 1, final output 1, etc.,
```

keeping the correct extensions. Every input, intermediate artifact and final output needs to be in the zip.

Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, request, workflow)

None

Metadata.rtf - The [Topology / Request / Task Description] section doesn't match the recording: ___. Topology should list every app visit in order as LOOKUP, CREATE or MODIFY, and Request must match the TaskRecorder Goal exactly.

Recording

Video acceptance length between 15:00 and 54:59

None

```
Video length - Your video is __:__ long, outside the reviewer
acceptance range of 15:00 to 54:59 including the intro and
epilogue. Please [plan a more complex workflow / simplify the
workflow] and re-record, planning for the writer guidance of 15:00
to 50:59.
```

Dock visible at start and end — 4

None

```
Dock visibility - The Dock was hidden at the during the recording.
Please keep the Dock visible for the whole recording, especially at
the start and end, and use ordinary Fill instead of Full Screen so
it stays on screen.
```

No app window covers more than 25% of another for over 6s (allowed up to 30s)

None

```
Window management - [App 1] covered [App 2] by more than 25% for
about __ seconds at MM:SS. Please use one Fill window or place task
windows side by side, and minimize windows you aren't using. Avoid
Full Screen and small floating windows. Pop-ups within the same app
are fine while in use.
```

Mouse never idle over 45s outside the closing epilogue

None

```
Mouse inactivity - The mouse was idle for about __ seconds at MM:SS
outside the closing epilogue. Please keep the cursor active as a
teaching pointer and keep any single pause under 45 seconds,
without artificial movement. Remember typing does not count as
```

mouse activity. The closing epilogue may be still; AutoQC excludes the final 5 minutes from this check. This technical buffer does not increase the 4:00 epilogue maximum.

Writer performance

Narration says What, Where and Why (≥70% on 2 of the 3)

None

Narration - The narration needs to be clear enough that a listener could follow the task without seeing the screen. Your task was missing [What / Where / Why] in several places, for example MM:SS, MM:SS and MM:SS. Name the action, the exact control and its location, and the reason, and avoid vague words like "here" and "this."

Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task

None

Workflow match - The recording doesn't complete the approved Goal: ___ [was skipped / was replaced with ___] at MM:SS. Please record the workflow as approved. If your plan changes materially, submit a change request in Studio before recording.

🖊️ Changelog of Reviewer Guidelines

Date	Details of changes
Oct 20, 2026	🟩 Reviewer and QC checklist are now aligned 🟩Reviewer Checklist: every item now states its fail point in option 4. [Automated] items are scored on the same 1–4 ranges as manual items. 🟩 Studio, Airtable, Mercor and Project Odin information (item 17) is now OK in the recording and no longer blocks approval. 🟩 Metadata.rtf (item 1): fails when it is under 80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or Studio. 🟩 Window overlap (item 2): 6–30 s is edge case; over 30 s fails. 🟩 What / Where / Why (item 3): fails when under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws. An action is anything that changes the state of the document. 🟩 Eyes Closed (item 4): 4 or more ambiguous references is edge case. A 2+ minute stretch narrated mostly with "here" and "this" fails. 🟩 NEW Intro length (item 8): 21–30 s is edge case; over 30 s fails. 🟩 Metadata.rtf shown (item 9): up to 10 s is edge case; over 10 s fails. 🟩 Typing (item 10): fails over 25% (over 35% for Coding / Content & Writing). 🟩 Silence (item 11): 46–60 s is edge case; over 60 s fails. 🟩 Background noise (item 12): 30–40% of narration is edge case; over 40% fails. 🟩 Profanity (item 19): minor on-screen profanity not typed by the writer is edge case. 🟩 Domain expertise (item 23): fails when a non-expert could do more than 10% of the actions. 🟩 Pace (item 24): 10–15% of the video above 220 WPM is edge case; over 15% fails. 🟩Missing epilogues DO NOT FAIL tasks regardless of approval date
Oct 19, 2026	🟩 Clarified that CC0, public domain, copyright, royalty free issues only apply to information that ends up in the deliverable.zip. Browsing websites with logos doesn’t violate our terms.

	🟩Clarified that while ideally project information is hidden (e.g., references to Mercor, Project Odin, Studio Instructions), they will be tolerated in small quantities and should not lead to task rejection on its own. 🟩**NEW - Epilogue narration requirements:** All task ideas originally approved at or after **Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT** must include an epilogue narration (target: 3-4 mins; maximum: 4:00; longer epilogues may be sent back) which serves as a brief reflection of the work. See here for more details 🟩Reviewer acceptance is up to 54:59 total, including intro and epilogue. Writer recording guidance remains no more than 50:59; the higher acceptance limit is not a writer target.
Oct 17, 2026	🟩 Clarified Insightful and pay for reviewers who write tasks (Getting Started). Promoted reviewers keep Insightful running and stay hourly while writing; directly hired reviewers do not run Insightful while writing.
Oct 16, 2026	App-policy update (effective 2026-10-16 18:08 PDT): Historical restriction entries below, including the blanket TextEdit ban, are superseded by the canonical three-category app list. TextEdit may be used for metadata.rtf; separate opening-Goal instructions remain unchanged. In-flight work is protected and now-allowed app rejections may be reconsidered subject to other quality checks.
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list - all tasks submitted before 10/14 5PM PST should be approved if their only failure mode was a restricted app on this list: 1. anatomyapp 2. Autodesk FBX Review 3. Defold 4. drawBook 5. FL Studio / FruitLoops Studio 6. GameMaker 7. JASP 8. KiCad 9. LTspice 10. Milanote 11. MohrPlotter 12. OpenVSP 13. Penpot

	14. qemu-system-aarch64 15. Sticky Notepad 16. Substance 3D Stager 17. TextExpander 18. VMD
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added “If the Reviewer raised the complexity issue in R1 and the writer didn’t fix it, then R2 can send back.” 🟩 Added DM templates
Oct 13, 2026	🟩 Added “The goal is to leave 1-2 sentences of feedback” 🟩 Added New Reviewer info: Run Insightful and Device Requirements
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 TextEdit is now fully restricted, including for filling out Metadata.rtf: the restricted app list entry “FOR METADATA.RTF ONLY - TextEdit.app” was changed to “TextEdit.app” (Odin Production Full Workflow world).
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 Full Facelift
Oct 11, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Express 3. Google Gemini 4. Google Play 5. Kali Linux 6. Screenshot 7. Splice 8. Steam 9. Trading View 10. WPS Office
Oct 10, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Acrobat 2. Adobe After Effects 3. Adobe Illustrator 4. Adobe InDesign 5. Adobe Premiere Pro 6. Antigravity IDE 7. App Store.app 8. Apple Music Classical 9. Cisco Packet Tracer 10. CleanMyMac X 11. Complete Anatomy 12. Dictionary.app 13. Font Book.app 14. Games.app 15. GoodNotes

	16. GraphPad Prism 17. Linear 18. Magnet 19. Maps.app 20. Mendeley 21. Microsoft Intune 22. Microsoft Store 23. Microsoft Support 24. Music.app 25. News.app 26. NVivo 27. Paprika Recipe Manager 28. Parallels Desktop 29. PDFgear 30. Podcasts.app 31. Shazam 32. Siri.app 33. SnapGene 34. Spotify 35. Substance 3D Painter 36. TradingView 37. UCSF Chimera 38. Wolfram Mathematica
Oct 4, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Core world): 1. Apple Compressor 2. Apple Motion 3. Final Cut Pro 4. iMovie 5. Keynote 6. Logic Pro 7. MainStage 8. Pages